CENTER FOR
STUDENT INVOLVEMENT
AMERICAN UNIVERSITY

Recognized Student Organization Manual

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Welcome & Overview

The Center for Student Involvement (CSI) is the hub for the student experience at American University. There are over 100 student organizations recognized under our office. The Division of Student Affairs (DSA) has given CSI the authority to establish policies and procedures for involvement opportunities through student-led recognized student organizations (RSOs). This manual has been created as a guide to assist RSOs in understanding those policies and procedures.

As a student organization leader, you are responsible for knowing, following, and educating others on the policies and procedures found here. If you have any questions about the following information, your CSI advisor is a great resource for support.

Please note that the content of this document is subject to change. Notice of any major changes will generally be distributed via email and updated on the CSI website. Minor changes may be made without formal notification. If you have any feedback about the manual, you can submit this form to CSI for review.

CSI's role on campus also includes, but is not limited to, the following:

- CSI provides advisement, oversight, and recognition for all boards and councils listed in this manual and their respective organizations. All councils and boards within CSI must abide by the policies outlined. Failure to do so may result in disciplinary action, which could include revocation of recognition.
- CSI recognizes student-led organizations through the new club registration, renewal, and reactivation processes. These processes do not impede students' rights to associate with each other on campus.
- CSI will grant the responsibilities and privileges of student organizations to student groups when they follow proper procedures to establish and maintain their groups through the appropriate processes.
- CSI is responsible for maintaining Engage, the primary online communication, financial, and event management system for recognized student organizations at American University. use and access for RSOs. Access to Engage will be limited to enrolled American University (AU) students, departments, and faculty and staff members that currently advise a student organization. Information contained in Engage is strictly limited to AU events and promotions only.
- CSI currently maintains an Instagram account and a section of the AU website, in addition to our Engage page. All social media accounts are used for promoting AU events, programs, and RSO information.
- CSI has the responsibility of assigning a staff advisor to each council or board. CSI Advisors are responsible for the oversight of day-to-day operations and fiscal management of the council or board. They reserve the right to make all final decisions concerning the council or board as they pertain to American University policy and finances. CSI Advisors are distinct from an RSO's faculty/staff advisor. RSOs select their own faculty/staff advisor as outlined in their constitutions; for more information, please see the **Faculty/Staff Advisor section** (pg. 37)**.**

CSI is on the 3rd floor of the Mary Graydon Student Center (MGSC) in MGSC 324. Feel free to come by to ask questions, engage in discussions about how to improve your organization, or say hi. We look forward to working with you in leading a successful student organization!

Meet Our Staff

Check out this document for the most up-to-date CSI advisor list.

- *Vacant*, Executive Director, Student Engagement & Student Center
- Matt Galewski mgalewski@american.edu, Sr. Associate Director, Training & Development
  Oversees: Recognized Student Organization portfolio, RSO accountability, AU Student Government
- Maura Fox mfox@american.edu, Associate Director, Student Involvement
  Oversees: Student Media, Graduate Leadership Council and Graduate School Councils, AU Student Government Senate and Undergraduate School Councils
- Samantha Easby seasby@american.edu, Associate Director of Fraternity and Sorority Life
  Oversees: FSL Policies, Advisor Support, Interfraternity Council and Intercultural Greek Collective
- Nadir McCoy nmccoy@american.edu, Assistant Director of Fraternity and Sorority Life
  Oversees: Leadership Development, programming, Intercultural Greek Collective and Panhellenic Council
- Alexis Fuentes afuentes@american.edu, Associate Director, Student Programs & Signature Events
  Oversees: Student Activity Council, Student Union Board, Kennedy Political Union, CSI Large Scale Programming, Departmental Marketing
- Sydney Avelino, Coordinator, Student Engagement & Traditions
  Oversees: Students for Change, Spirit and Traditions Board, CSI Large Scale Programming, Departmental Marketing
- Luz Torres-Patterson luzp@american.edu, Assistant Director of Finance and Operations
  Oversees: Finances, Front Desk
- Marcus McNeil mmcneil@american.edu, Finance and Operations Coordinator
  Oversees: Finances

Stay Connected

- Email: *studentinvolvement@american.edu*
- AU Website: https://www.american.edu/student-affairs/student-involvement/
- Engage: https://american.campuslabs.com/engage/organization/getinvolved
- Instagram: https://www.instagram.com/auinvolvement/

CSI Governance Groups

The governance groups, boards and councils listed below provide day-to-day oversight for organization programming, leadership selection processes, and allocation of funds for their cohorts with the support and advisement of CSI Advisors. Governance groups are considered university-sponsored groups, as defined on page 11 of this manual.

- **American University Club Council (AUCC)** is charged with supporting, promoting, developing, and managing undergraduate recognized student organizations and their funding allocation process.
- **American University Student Government (AUSG)** provides governance and advocacy on behalf of the undergraduate AU campus community. Each school also has its own governing body, known as the **Undergraduate Councils (UGCs)**, that provides support and advocacy for its students.
- **Fraternity & Sorority Life (FSL)** within CSI provides recognition, advisement, and day-to-day oversight to the councils below, as well as the individual chapters under each council.
    - **Interfraternity Council (IFC):** governs all men's social fraternities that are, or have been, historically recognized by the North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC)
        - **North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC)** - *https://nicfraternity.org*
    - **Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC):** governs the member chapters of recognized culturally based fraternal organizations under the National Pan-Hellenic Council (NPHC) and the National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations (NALFO)
        - **National Pan-Hellenic Council -** *https://www.nphchq.com/*
        - **National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations -** *https://nalfo.org/*
    - **Panhellenic Council (PHC):** governs all women's social sororities recognized by the National Panhellenic Conference (NPC)
        - **National Panhellenic Conference -** *https://npcwomen.org/*
- The **Graduate Leadership Council (GLC)** is the representative body for graduate students at AU. They assist with advocacy and programming for graduate students and collaborate with and oversee the **Graduate Student Councils (GSCs)**, graduate student organizations, and graduate student activity fee allocations.
- The **Student Activity Council (SAC)** is the student-run governing body for programming that offers a wide range of activities and events to enhance the student experience at American University. It oversees four programming boards:
    - Spirit & Traditions Board (STB)
    - Kennedy Political Union (KPU),
    - Student Union Board (SUB), and
    - Students for Change (SFC)
- The **Student Media Board (SMB)** is a collaborative effort of recognized student-run media organizations. It is responsible for the governance and funding allocation of these organizations.

Second Floor Space, Storage, & Usage

RSOs have access to storage and meeting space within their governance board's Second Floor suites. These storage spaces are for general organizational use and must follow all guidelines established by the Center for Student Involvement and Mary Graydon Student Center, which can be reviewed in the ***MGSC Second Floor Space and Usage Agreement***.

Organization Operating Procedures

In addition to this manual and AU policies and procedures, some CSI governance groups, as referenced in this manual, are subject to their own operating procedures to address their unique operational needs. All operating procedures managed by governance groups must comply with this manual and AU policies and procedures. In the event of a conflict, this manual and AU policies and procedures supersede governance group operating procedures. Below is a list of the most up-to-date governing documents for groups:

- Student Media Board Standard Operating Procedures
    - Student Media Prepublication Support
- Student Activity Council Operating Procedures
- American University Club Council Funding Principles
- Interfraternity Council Constitution
- Intercultural Greek Collective Constitution
- Panhellenic Council Constitution

Moreover, Student Media organizations have additional responsibilities to promote ethical journalism at AU as stated below:

1. **Purpose and Scope:** It is the responsibility of each student media organization to ensure that their organizational structures and procedures allow for an inclusive and engaging educational experience for those involved. Their constitutions cannot be in conflict with the standards or procedures outlined herein. If there is a conflict, the Center for Student Involvement shall be consulted and will resolve the conflict.
2. **Student Media Board:** The Student Media Board is established under the Center for Student Involvement as a collaborative effort of recognized student-run media organizations. It is responsible for the governance and funding allocation of student-run media organizations. It shall provide support and accountability to ensure the development and continuation of student-produced media at American University. The Student Media Board does not have authority over editorial decisions and shall not engage in content review or censorship.
    a. **Members:** The most up-to-date list of student media organizations under the Student Media Board can be found on Engage.
    b. **Rights**
        i. **Freedom of Expression:** Student media organizations and contributors are free to publish or broadcast on matters of public concern or campus interest, including critical perspectives on institutional policies or leadership, provided that such content does not violate applicable laws or university policies related to discrimination, harassment, or individual safety.
        ii. **Protection from Retaliation:** Students involved in recognized media organizations shall not be subject to disciplinary action, retaliation, or adverse treatment for engaging in lawful journalistic activities or expressing opinions through their student media role.
        iii. **Editorial Independence:** Student journalists are responsible for determining the news, opinion, feature, and advertising content of Student Media-recognized work. No student media will be subjected to mandatory pre-publication review by university administrators, faculty, or employees prior to publication or withheld from distribution. Advisors are encouraged to work with student editors to seek

expert advice when stories present legal risks, as outlined in the Prepublication Support for Student Media. By way of example and not limitation, University officials or those acting on their behalf cannot:

1. Ban student expression solely because it is controversial, takes extreme, "fringe," or minority opinions, or is distasteful, unpopular, or unpleasant.
2. Censor or punish the occasional use of indecent, vulgar, or so called "four-letter" words in student publications.
3. Prohibit criticism of the policies, practices, or performance of faculty, college officials, the college itself, or of any public officials.
4. Censor a publication or punish or fire student editors for grammatical, spelling, or other errors that may diminish the "quality" of student media.
5. Cut off funds to official student media because of disagreement over editorial policy.
6. Ban the publication or distribution by students of material written by non-students.
7. Engage in any activity or cause to be done to student media anything where the effect is to control, diminish, manipulate, or otherwise censor student media or to dismiss, punish, or retaliate against student media staff where such action is motivated by the otherwise lawful content or newsgathering activities of student media.

c. **Responsibilities**

i. **Code of Ethics:** Student Media organizations will abide by their own Code of Ethics that has been established in their governing documents. In addition, they will also abide by the following procedures:

1. Produce media based upon professional standards of accuracy, objectivity, and fairness.
2. Review material to improve sentence structure, grammar, spelling, and punctuation.
3. Reasonably check and verify all facts and the accuracy of quotations.
4. Do not plagiarize or violate copyright.
5. Follow the standards of journalistic integrity and ethical practice.
6. In the case of editorials or letters to the editor concerning controversial issues, determine the need for rebuttal comments and opinions and provide space or airtime, if appropriate.
7. As stated in the Associated Collegiate Press Code of Ethics, journalists in Student Media must be responsible, fair, honest, accurate, independent, accountable, and minimize harm. Students are also encouraged to follow ethical journalism practices by prioritizing honesty, impartiality, transparency, and respect, while treating all individuals with decency and compassion.

ii. **Legal Compliance:** Student journalists must comply with applicable laws and university policies, including those relating to defamation, intellectual property, privacy, and responsible use of university technology and facilities.

iii. **Liability:** The University assumes no liability for the content of any student media over which it exercises no editorial control. The University urges all student

journalists to recognize that with editorial control comes responsibility and potential liability for all content and newsgathering decisions. Students who are members of recognized Student Media organizations determine the content of their respective media organizations and are responsible for that content. The editorial freedom of student journalists requires adherence to the principles of responsible journalism. Media shall not:

1. Be libelous or slanderous.
2. Constitute an unwarranted invasion of privacy.
3. Be obscene.
4. Violate federal or state law.
5. Violate university policies.
6. Incite students to create a clear and present danger of the commission of an unlawful act or the violation of university policy.

iv. **Media Law Training:** All student editors and contributors of recognized media organizations are required to attend an annual media law and ethics training hosted by the Center for Student Involvement in collaboration with the Office of General Counsel generally at the start of each school year. Attendance will be tracked and is mandatory for continued participation in leadership or editorial roles.

v. **Respect for Institutional Values:** Content should reflect the university's commitment to Inclusive Excellence, mutual respect, and constructive dialogue, even when expressing dissenting or controversial views.

vi. **Views and Opinions:** Any views, opinions, and content published by any Student Media organization are solely those of the individual authors and do not represent the views, beliefs, or official positions of American University, its administration, faculty, staff, or the student body as a whole. The university does not endorse or assume responsibility for any opinions expressed within media publications.

3. **Complaints and Accountability Process:** Student media organizations will be expected to follow the RSO accountability and resolution procedure that is outlined in this handbook.
4. **Faculty Advisors to Student Media Organizations**
    a. **Faculty Fellow for Student Media:** The Faculty Fellow for Student Media advises Student Media organizations, offering guidance in journalism practices, professional development, and organizational development. The Faculty Fellow provides expertise, serves as a key resource for student writers , and acts as a trusted partner on issues such as copyright, defamation, and journalistic integrity.
        i. **Role and Responsibilities of the Faculty Fellow:** They serve as a mentor, advisor, and liaison to recognized student media organizations on journalism practices, leadership, and organizational needs. They also as the primary point of contact for student editors requesting independent pre-publication reviews, coordinating with the Office of General Counsel, and provide guidance on copyright, defamation, intellectual property, and other legal considerations related to student-produced content. In collaboration with the CSI Student Media Advisor, the Faculty Fellow reviews and recommends policy updates and facilitates training and professional development curriculum related to student media.

b. **Role and Responsibilities of Student Media Organizations' Faculty Advisors:** Faculty advisors to student media organizations serve as mentors, guides, and educators, providing support and training to students involved in journalism while upholding the principles of press freedom. Faculty advisors do not control or censor student content, but act as resources to enhance the quality, accuracy, and ethical integrity of student publications.
c. **Editorial Independence and Ethical Guidance:**
    i. Faculty advisors are not responsible for student-generated content and do not engage in censorship. Their role is to mentor and provide guidance while allowing students to maintain editorial independence.
    ii. Advisors shall help students recognize and address potential ethical and legal concerns in their work, as well as work to ensure that published content adheres to professional journalistic standards, avoiding libel, factual inaccuracies, copyright infringement, and plagiarism.
    iii. Advisors shall work with the Center for Student Involvement to support required media organization training each semester.
    iv. Advisors shall work to instill an understanding of high-quality writing, journalistic integrity, and the legal and historical foundations of the press.
    v. Faculty advisors are encouraged to use their on-campus office hours to provide student support and coaching to their student media organization. Advisors shall make it known that they are available for guidance, counseling, and assistance as needed.
    vi. Advisors shall work collaboratively with student leaders and university administrators to support the sustainability and ethical integrity of student media.

Both the Faculty Fellow and Faculty Advisors should offer pre-publication advice if requested, including working with the Office of General Counsel when necessary, and provide constructive post-publication feedback.

Eligibility for CSI Leadership Positions

"Student leaders," for the purposes of this manual, are defined as any undergraduate or graduate students serving (a) in the President, Treasurer, EMS Requestor, or Secretary role of their RSO; (b) on a governance board; or (c) as a member of AU Student Government.

Requirements for applying for, running for, and holding a leadership position include:

- All undergraduate student leaders must have a minimum cumulative grade point average of 2.50 for all hours earned at American University and/or their previous educational institution if the student is a transfer student in their first semester at AU. Graduate student leaders must have a minimum cumulative 3.00 grade point average.
- All student leaders must be in good disciplinary standing with AU and not on a conduct status of disciplinary probation or higher.
- Student leaders must be enrolled at AU for at least twelve (12) undergraduate credit hours or six (6) graduate credit hours each semester and pay their respective Student Activity Fee.
    - Students who are taking less than the required minimum credit hours may submit an appeal to the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center for an exception. The Executive Director will coordinate with any relevant campus offices to review exemption requests as needed. Appeal criteria to be considered include:
        - Explanation of why a student is registered for less than the required credit hours
        - Review of that student's membership in the organization
        - The organization's support for the student serving in that position
        - Any corroborating details
    - Students who are taking a leave of absence, taking classes entirely online, participating in a graduate certificate program, or participating in Study Abroad are not eligible to hold leadership positions because they do not pay the Student Activity Fee.
        - Students may not hold more than two (2) paid leadership positions within CSI. Students also cannot hold more than one council/board head position (i.e., AUCC Chair and SAC Co-Chair, Student Media Board Chair and AUSG President, etc.).
- Those positions that receive student support payments must complete the required paperwork by the CSI Finance deadline to receive payment each semester. Student support payments are not salaries, nor do they make student leaders employees of the university. Student leadership rosters are updated by the first day of classes each semester. Student organizations will then have three weeks from that date to complete and return all required paperwork.
    - Deadlines are as follows:
        - **Fall Semester:** September 13, 2026
        - **Spring Semester:** January 31, 2027
    - Students who do not serve in the associated leadership role for the entire semester will have their support payment pro-rated by the number of weeks in the position.

Student Organization Definitions, Rights, & Responsibilities

This section covers the definitions, benefits, and responsibilities of a recognized student organization.

Recognized Student Organization Recognition Definitions

Student organizations can receive official AU recognition in one of three ways:

- Recognition from CSI
- Recognition as a club sport through Recreational Sports & Fitness
- Recognition through the respective Office of the Dean of the College or a Departmental group.

The University utilizes the following definitions for student groups:

1. **University-Sponsored Organization-** Also known as governance boards, these are student-led governance organizations that contribute to the University's general goals and benefit or serve many students; a CSI staff advisor is required.
2. **Informal Group:** an informal gathering of faculty, staff, or students. These groups are not recognized as formal University Groups and may include casual social groups or ad hoc groups formed around shared interests or activities. The University may address incidents of misconduct that involve informal groups through individual conduct charges.
3. **Organization Seeking Recognition:** an organization that has initiated a recognition process through a department such as the Center for Student Involvement and has not been granted provisional status. Organizations seeking recognition are subject to the Student Conduct Code and all relevant American University policies in the same manner as recognized student organizations. Organizations seeking recognition are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. The University may address incidents of misconduct involving organizations seeking recognition through organizational and/or individual conduct charges.
    a. Organizations seeking recognition that violate University policies may be held accountable as individuals and/or as an organization with sanctions that may include the denial or deferral of its application for recognition. If an organization's application was denied or deferred, and it reapplies within two years, it must first meet with CSI staff to review the deferral/denial. The organization must also demonstrate how it has addressed the previous issues in its application, materials, and presentation.
    b. Once approved, new recognized student organizations will have the benefits and responsibilities tied to recognition, including the public use of American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets. Until such time that an organization seeking recognition is approved, they may not publicly use American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets, including on social media, except for the explicit purposes of recruitment and activities tied to the New Club Registration process as defined by the Center for Student Involvement or recognizing department.
4. **Provisionally Recognized Student Organization**: a student-led group that has received provisional status through a recognition process from the Center for Student Involvement and an inter/national organization that has been approved to pursue recognition under one of the Fraternity and Sorority Life councils. Provisionally recognized organizations are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. The University may address incidents of misconduct involving

groups who have received provisional recognition through organizational and/or individual conduct charges.

   a. Once approved, new recognized student organizations will have the benefits and responsibilities tied to recognition, including the public use of American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets. Until such time that provisionally recognized student organization is approved, they may not publicly use American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets, including on social media, except for the explicit purposes of recruitment and activities tied to the provisionally recognized process as defined by the Center for Student Involvement or recognizing department.
   b. Provisionally recognized student organizations that receive initial approval to go through the registration process will be considered for 'Recognized' status for the following academic semester upon completion of all required recognition components.
   c. Provisionally recognized student organizations are held to the same conduct expectations as organizations seeking recognition.

5. **Recognized Student Organization (RSO)**: a student-led and created group that has been formally recognized by the Center for Student Involvement or another university department and has benefits and responsibilities tied to recognition. The University may address incidents of misconduct involving groups who have received recognition through organizational and/or individual conduct charges.
   a. Any RSO that completes the proper procedures for registration and meets set requirements is eligible to receive the privileges and responsibilities associated with being a recognized student organization. Recognition must be received from the proper council or board, as delineated by CSI.
6. **Unrecognized Student Organization:** Unrecognized student organizations include groups that have never been formally recognized through the Center for Student Involvement or any other university department, groups that were once previously organizations seeking recognition, and previously recognized organizations that have been denied recognition or have lost their recognition due to administrative reasons. Unrecognized student organizations are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. Behavioral incidents involving an unrecognized group will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Unrecognized student organizations are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets.
7. **Separated Organization:** a formerly recognized student organization or group that has lost University recognition on a permanent basis as a consequence of violations of the Code and/or other policies. Separation is permanent removal (i.e. expulsion) from the university community and permanent loss of all privileges of recognition. Behavioral incidents involving such organizations will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Separated Organizations are not affiliated with American University and are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets.
8. **Underground Group:** a formerly recognized student organization or group that has lost university recognition on a permanent basis as a consequence of violations of the Code and/or other policies and continues to operate and function despite the directive not to do so. Underground groups are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. Behavior incidents involving an underground group will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Underground groups are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other

official/registered assets.

9. **Fraternities & Sororities:** social Greek-lettered organizations are defined as single-sex*, selective, and values-based; they must go through the FSL extension or expansion process to be recognized by CSI.
    a. *Membership and all privileges, including voting and officer positions, must be extended only to all currently enrolled AU students without regard to age, ethnicity, gender, disability, color, national origin, race, religion, sexual orientation, or veteran status. Title IX of the Educational Amendment of 1972, Section 106.14 makes an exception for social fraternities and sororities regarding gender for membership criteria.
    b. *Note:* Professional fraternities are organizations whose primary purpose is to promote the interests of a particular profession and whose membership is restricted to students in a particular field of professional education or study; service fraternities and sororities focus on community service. These differ from the social fraternities and sororities that are housed under FSL.

Recognized Student Organization Responsibilities

Organization officers are tasked with being the leaders of their general membership; they are responsible for the actions, conduct, and activities performed by themselves, as well as those of organization members acting on the organization's behalf. It is the responsibility of each individual RSO to complete required trainings, including:

- Student Leader Orientation and Policy Training (President) - an introduction to the office and university policies, including the Student Code of Conduct and nondiscrimination policies.
- Governance Board Finance Training (Treasurer; President highly encouraged)- for organizations recognized under AUCC or GLC, this explains the finance policies and budget requests established by either governance board
- CSI Finance Training (Treasurer; President highly encouraged)- explains how to access funding for your organization, and their usage. including how to create a purchase request.
- Programming Training (EMS Requestor and the equivalent of your Events Coordinator) - an overview of event timelines and the steps to putting on a successful event
- Building Inclusive Organizations Training (at least one of the following positions- President, Treasurer, Secretary, EMS Requestor- but all are encouraged) - teaches how to lead inclusively, navigate difficult conversations within your organization, effectively build community, and utilize conflict resolution strategies.
- Advisor Training (Faculty/Staff Advisor) - Resources, policies and practices for staff and faculty that serve as student organization advisors.

Failure to complete any required trainings may result in the RSO being frozen, recognition being denied, or losing access to organizational privileges or benefits, such as the ability to reserve space on campus or utilize funding.

Student organizations must re-register each academic year and complete the appropriate annual requirements, such as the required trainings. Failure to register annually or complete the annual requirements may result in revocation of the organization's recognized status.

Additional responsibilities of organizations leaders include, but are not limited to, receiving communications from the University and disseminating information as appropriate; ensuring that the organization abides by all University policies; and communicating in a timely fashion with the CSI Advisor

and/or the faculty/staff advisor information that is impacting the operations of the organization.

Recognized student organizations under CSI must also be aware of the following:

- Activities and functions must abide by all CSI, University, and Student Code of Conduct policies, as well as local and federal laws. Organizations that are under investigation for alleged violations of university policy are not permitted to participate in annual renewal, RSO reactivation, new club registration, or RSO duplication processes until that investigation is resolved. Organizations that continue to meet the necessary requirements following an investigation may be permitted to engage in the processes outlined in this manual, per the policies and expectations of those processes. Student organizations recognized by an international/national organization must also abide by policies consistent with university policies. Activities and functions that do not follow CSI policy or guidelines will be denied.
- All recognized student organizations are required to have a faculty/staff advisor. Recognized student organizations and their leadership have an obligation to build a productive relationship with their advisors by keeping their advisors informed of organizational activities, promptly responding to communication from their advisors, seeking them out as a resource for support or when there are concerns, and meeting with their advisors at least once per semester. Advisors must be an AU faculty or staff member who is considered a full-time university employee. Fraternities and Sororities must have a chapter advisor that is in good standing with their inter/national organization, as well as a faculty/staff advisor on campus. Refer to the Faculty/Staff Advisor section of this manual on page 36 for information regarding advisor expectations.
- During every annual renewal process, executive board leadership, faculty/staff advisor, and an updated membership roster must be provided on Engage.
- Presidents of RSOs must be elected by their general body members.
- CSI hosts an annual summit where attendance is mandatory.
- Any changes to an RSO's constitution must be conducted under the amendment procedure stated in the RSO's constitution, shared with your CSI advisor, and uploaded to the organization's Engage page once approved.
- RSO Presidents, Treasurers, Secretaries and EMS Requestors are required to complete training in hazing prevention and bystander education trainings.
- RSOs must attend at least 1 continuing education or leadership education program each year, as published and determined by. Failure to complete any required trainings may result in the RSO being frozen or losing access to organizational privileges or benefits, such as the ability to reserve space on campus or utilize funding.
- General events, meetings, and programs must be open to the campus community and advertised through Engage with the date, time, location, and hosting organization.
- Recognition of student organizations by CSI shall not imply support for any student organization's purpose, philosophy, or activities. The university will not assume legal liabilities for any student organization's activities that have not been previously approved and follow University policy.
- The use of the AU logo, wordmark, and signatures is restricted to AU colleges, departments, and administrative units. Student organizations may use the logo but cannot change it, the wordmark, or signatures. Guidelines for logo usage can be found at *https://www.american.edu/ucm/resources.cfm*

The organization and its officers are responsible for all programs, actions, or commitments made on behalf

of the organization, including their debts. AU is not liable for debts incurred by the student organization that have not been preapproved by the Center for Student Involvement. Responsibility for any action which violates federal, state, and local laws and ordinances or university policies is assumed by the individual group's officers and members.

Recognized Student Organization Benefits

CSI recognized student organizations are entitled to the following benefits:

- Use of University facilities as established within each university department and access to AU's online space scheduling system, EMS, which is managed by University Event Scheduling
- An official American University email. *Note:* Please see the Responsible Use of University Technology Resources Policy.
- Ability to sponsor and promote activities
- Access to the Engage, the online organization management platform overseen by CSI, to manage organizational operations, communications, and finances
- Funding from Student Activity Fees, provided the use of the SAF is for organization activities that all students have the opportunity to participate in
- Participation in campus-wide events sponsored by Student Activity Fees
- Being listed in CSI publications, including directories and websites
- Opportunity to promote your organization at student organization fairs
- Ability to table in designated locations across campus
- Access to a faculty/staff advisor. *Note:* CSI manages a repository of interested advisors and can be a resource if you are thinking of starting an organization, having trouble finding an advisor, or needing a new advisor.
- Posting and advertising privileges, per AU's Posting Policy
- Use of printing services
- Using the AU name, logo, and seal per university guidelines
- Ability to use the Center for Student Involvement campus office for your organization address and package/mail delivery

Organization Categories

RSOs fall under one of the following categories based on their primary activities and mission:

- Academic/Professional
- Advocacy
- Graduate
- Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC)
- Inter-fraternity Council (IFC)
- Multicultural
- Panhellenic Council
- Performing Arts
- Political
- Professional Greek Organization
- Programming
- Service
- Social
- Spiritual/Faith-Based
- Student Governance
- Student Media

Official Recognition

Organization Names

Recognized student organizations may not use the name of any other recognized student organization or campus office, department, or initiative without prior written approval. CSI reserves the right to deny the use of organization names that are deemed inappropriate, denigrating, or misleading; that use trademarked references without written permission; or that are related to other student organizations and/or campus departments to an extent that may cause confusion.

Recognized student organizations must conduct business and promotions in the same name in which they are registered with the Center for Student Involvement and listed in Engage. Recognized student organizations who choose to include American University in their name must include American University at the end (*ex: [Organization Name] at American University* or *[Organization Name] AU).* No alteration of the University logo or marks is allowed without permission from University Communications & Marketing (UCM). The university reserves the right to review and revoke the usage of logos and marks.

Requests by a recognized student organization to change its name must be submitted to CSI via email at studentinvolvement@american.edu for approval. CSI will consult with the leaders of the recognized student organization to determine if the name change would result in a change in the organization's purpose, mission, or scope, its impact on any other recognized student organizations, affiliations or associations with any national or international organizations, and if such a change would require the group to go through the new club registration process. If CSI determines the name change can proceed without the group going through the new club registration process, the organization must update its constitution and Engage page prior to the change taking effect.

Annual Renewal

Annual Renewal is the process CSI uses for currently recognized student organizations to continue recognition for the next academic year. If an organization does not renew, it will be considered frozen and will have to wait to reactivate until the next reactivation process. To initiate the process, RSOs can re-register on Engage and include the following information:

- The organization's Constitution that reflects the most up-to-date CSI policies
- The organization's roster with an updated executive board and a removal of graduated students
- The organization's Engage page summary information that reflects the manual's Openness & Inclusion Expectations.
- Completion of required trainings

Recognized Student Organization (RSO) status is a privilege granted by the University and is subject to annual renewal in accordance with the requirements outlined in this manual. In certain circumstances, an RSO may be placed under interim restrictions and/or disciplinary sanctions by the Dean of Students Office and/or the Office of Equity and Title IX pending review of potential policy violations, climate concerns, as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here). If such restrictions and/or sanctions include a requirement that prevents an RSO from operating and that requirement remains in effect during the annual renewal period, the RSO's recognition shall be considered lapsed until the matter is resolved. In these cases:

- The RSO must work directly with the Center for Student Involvement (CSI) to pursue renewal either
    - through the next scheduled renewal cycle, or
    - through an abbreviated or late renewal process, at the sole discretion of the Executive

Director of Student Engagement and Student Center based on the nature of the restrictions/sanctions, timing of the restrictions/sanctions being lifted, and feasibility for the RSO to sufficiently complete the requirements.

- The terms of the disciplinary letter or notice of restrictions/sanctions will guide the above determination.
- RSOs that are suspended from the university (or are placed on a status that prevents them from renewing their recognition) for more than 2 years thus have missed the window in which to renew or reactivate and must reapply via new club registration.
- These same expectations apply to RSO Reactivation and Duplication processes.

Frozen Student Organizations

Recognized student organizations are frozen when they do not complete the year's Annual Renewal or when CSI determines they have failed to follow CSI policies and directives. Frozen RSOs do not have any privileges of recognized student organizations. Frozen RSOs looking to become active again must be reactivated. Please see the RSO reactivation section below for the reactivation process. Organizations frozen for 2 or more years will be considered unrecognized and will be required to participate in the New Club Registration process if they wish to be considered active again. For the purposes of this policy, 2 years will be defined as 2 years from the end of the last academic semester in which the RSO was active before it was frozen.

RSO Reactivation

When an RSO does not complete the Annual Renewal requirements, they are automatically placed in a frozen status. The RSO Reactivation process, which occurs concurrently with the new club registration process, is intended for RSOs seeking to regain recognition from the Center for Student Involvement after they've been frozen. Before applying for reactivation, frozen RSOs should:

- Review Engage for the full list of existing organizations to ensure that your club has a unique mission not yet fulfilled by an existing recognized organization.
    - If your club's mission is already fulfilled by an existing recognized organization, your application will be denied, and you will be encouraged to join said organization. For any group that is similar to an existing student organization or organization seeking recognition, CSI reserves the right to deny the reactivating group's application, defer or deny the organization seeking recognition, or defer/deny both, at any point in the process. To the extent possible, CSI will prioritize connecting students from both groups so they have the opportunity to consolidate or distinguish efforts. The above expectations apply to multiple reactivating groups that are similar.
    - If Engage does not have an archived record of the Recognized Student Organization proposing to be reactivated, it must be recognized through the New Club Registration process.
- Contact studentinvolvement@american.edu to confirm the operational status of the recognized student organization that is in a frozen status you are trying to reactivate.

Frozen organizations that satisfy all requirements of the reactivation process, including student leader eligibility requirements and other requirements of RSOs as outlined in this manual, will be approved as recognized student organizations, pending final verification by the Executive Director. The Executive Director's role here is to verify that organizations that are slated for approval have satisfied all of the

requirements, including a check that Engage pages and constitutions comply with all relevant university policies. Once verification takes place, organizations that have successfully satisfied all requirements will be notified of the official recognition decision. Groups that receive notice of final approval must have their Engage pages fully updated within 5 business days. Fully approved organizations are encouraged to meet with CSI and their governance board to support a successful onboarding experience.

RSO Duplication (Graduate vs. Undergraduate RSOs)

Students of one academic level (undergraduate or graduate) may create a corresponding branch of an already existing organization (i.e., First-Generation Graduate Society is the graduate branch of the original undergraduate organization, First-Generation Student Union). Students interested in creating such a branch, can complete the "Organization Duplication For Graduate/Undergraduate Partnerships" form available on CSI's Engage page. As with starting any organization at AU, requirements for approval include:

- A roster of at least 8 student members of the same academic level (graduate or undergraduate) based on the organization's classification, including a President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requester.
    - The EMS Requester position can be held simultaneously with another executive board position. The President and Treasurer positions cannot be held by the same individual.
    - *Note:* The advisor to the recognized student organization is not included in the 8-member requirement.
- A full-time AU faculty/staff advisor, including completion of requirements
- An RSO constitution (it can be the same constitution as the currently active organization, but with changes that pertain specifically to that academic level)
- The student proposing the organization is currently a full-time student at American University
- RSO duplication must adhere to the same standards for Engage pages, constitutions, distinctiveness compared to existing groups, and final verification requirements, that organizations seeking recognition and reactivating groups are held to.
- The proposed organization must have a similar name to the currently active organization, with "graduate" or "undergraduate" as a distinguishing feature.
- The proposed group must satisfy all requirements of the reactivation process, including student leader eligibility requirements and other requirements of RSOs as outlined in this manual.

New Club Registration

The new club registration (NCR) process is for undergraduate and graduate students looking to start an organization and gain recognized status with the Center for Student Involvement. Students interested in starting a new club must follow the outlined process established by the Center for Student Involvement. Organizations seeking recognition that receive final approval for registration will receive 'Recognized' status beginning the following academic semester.

Organizations Seeking Recognition

Groups going through the new club registration process, from the point a group submits an application until they receive their recognition decision, are considered **organizations seeking recognition**. Organizations seeking recognition are not entitled to any of the benefits of recognized student organizations.

Organizational Conduct Expectations

Organizations seeking recognition are held to the same policies and expectations of recognized student organizations.

Approval of any organization seeking recognition requires that the organization, including individual applicant(s), as defined in this policy, does not meet any of the following disqualifying criteria:

a. currently subject to sanctions or other actions related to violation(s) of university policy as determined in consultation with the Office of Equity and Title IX and the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices;
b. the organization seeking recognition is currently under investigation by the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices and/or the Dean of Students office for allegations of misconduct under university policy;
c. the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices has determined that the organization seeking recognition's conduct has created or contributed to: (1) a hostile environment and/or (2) a climate concern, as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here);
d. or the organization's application for recognition has been denied or deferred for the current iteration of new club registration due to: (1) an active investigation related to an allegation or a finding of misconduct under university policy or (2) a determination of misconduct or a climate concern as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here).

The Center for Student Involvement, in consultation with the Office of Equity and Title IX and/or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices, shall determine whether a deferral of recognition is warranted for organizations seeking recognition under review by any of these offices concerning a climate-related concern or a potential violation of university policy, in circumstances where a formal investigation has not been initiated.

Individuals and/or the organization seeking recognition may be held accountable for alleged misconduct in accordance with University policies. Sanctions may include the denial or deferral of application for recognition of the organization seeking recognition.

If a university employee receives a report regarding alleged misconduct by an organization seeking recognition, the employee is expected to direct the complainant to the appropriate university office or form(s) to report their concerns. Only allegations of misconduct that have been reviewed by the appropriate University office will be considered in decisions regarding an organization's recognition.

An organization seeking recognition may continue its progress in the registration process unless and until it is notified of an investigation of alleged misconduct pursuant to university policy, or the Office of Equity and Title IX and/or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices has determined that the organization seeking recognition's conduct has created or contributed to: (1) a hostile environment or other forms of misconduct and/or (2) a climate concern within the university community. If an investigation is underway, the Center for Student Involvement will notify the organization seeking recognition that due to the pending conduct matter, the group's progress in the registration process will be deferred.

If the initial assessment of the complaint and/or investigation is not resolved within three weeks from receipt of the report by the relevant office, the relevant office will reach out to the Center for Student Involvement to share this update. The Center for Student Involvement will then inform the organization seeking recognition that due to the unresolved conduct matter, the organization will not be eligible for recognition in that registration cycle, its application will be deferred, and it may reapply in the next

iteration of the registration cycle if it meets all requirements imposed by university policy and the investigating office.

If the investigation of alleged misconduct results in a finding that there was a policy violation, and there are sanctions or other actions implemented by the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices, the organization's application for recognition may be denied.

If the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability conducts an investigation into alleged misconduct that results in a finding that there was **no policy violation**, however, the office determines that the organization's conduct created or contributed to a climate concern, the Center for Student Involvement will defer the application for a period no longer than one year, during which time the organization seeking recognition may be required by the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices to complete educational trainings as noted below, in order to reapply. The Center for Student Involvement may also require additional educational trainings beyond those listed below:

- **Accountability and Reflective Meeting**
  The executive board and their advisor are required to attend a 1-hour meeting with professional staff from CSI, the Dean of Students Office, and/or the Office of Equity and Title IX. This meeting will focus on discussing the impact of the group's behavior, exploring root causes, and co-developing an action plan that outlines future expectations and strategies to prevent recurrence, agreed upon by organization leadership and the university. Upon successful completion, CSI will maintain documentation of the agreed upon action plan, indicating this requirement has been satisfied.
- **Climate Impact Training**
  The executive board must participate in a training session led by the Office of Inclusive Excellence related to campus climate, inclusion, and community standards. Following the session, the group is required to submit a reflection or summary demonstrating their understanding of how their actions impacted the broader AU community, particularly in terms of campus climate and student well-being. Upon successful completion, CSI will document relevant learning outcomes achieved, indicating this requirement has been satisfied.
- **Restorative Engagement with CART**
  The executive board must engage with the **Campus Climate Action Response Team** (CART) to design and implement restorative practices. This may include a formal acknowledgment of harm, a restorative dialogue or circle, and/or initiatives aimed at building trust with affected communities or groups. Upon successful completion, CART will submit documentation to CSI indicating this requirement has been satisfied.
- **Community Education Project**
  The executive board will be required to develop and implement a peer education initiative or awareness campaign aligned with relevant issues. This may include hosting a campus event, creating an educational resource, or facilitating a discussion or workshop in collaboration with CSI or another campus partner. Upon successful completion, CSI or a relevant campus partner who collaborated with the organization on the initiative will document the positive impact of the project, indicating this requirement has been satisfied.

If the organization seeking recognition refuses to participate in this educational process as outlined above, the group may be denied recognition.

Key definitions:

- A "**climate concern**," is defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence here.
- "**Under review**," for the purposes of this policy, is defined as an initial assessment to determine whether the concerning conduct, if true, could constitute a policy violation.
- "**Investigation,**" for the purposes of this policy, is defined as a thorough and impartial formal process that affords all parties notice and opportunity to present evidence in determining whether a policy violation has occurred.
- "**Applicants**," for the purposes of this policy, are defined as the following individuals holding any of the following positions within the organization seeking recognition: President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requestor.
- "**Good disciplinary standing**," for the purposes of this policy, is defined as an individual student not being on a conduct sanction of probation or higher.

At any point in the process, the Center for Student Involvement may reasonably determine that due to the length of time elapsed between the responsible office's receipt of a report of misconduct and the initial assessment process, review process, or investigation, that a group would not have sufficient time to complete the remaining requirements and trainings for the registration process. In such cases, the Center for Student Involvement may inform the organization seeking recognition that it is no longer eligible for recognition in that registration cycle but may reapply in the next application cycle if it meets all policy requirements.

See the Deferral and Denials section within this policy for more information.

Executive Board Member Eligibility

Students in leadership and executive board positions for the organization seeking recognition must be in good disciplinary standing with the University. Student conduct records for those in the following leadership positions will be confirmed by CSI: President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requestor. These individuals must not currently be subject to sanctions related to violation(s) of university policy as determined in consultation with the Office of Equity and Title IX and the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices.

Students in leadership and executive board positions for the organization seeking recognition must have a cumulative grade point average of 2.5 for all hours earned at American University and/or their previous educational institution if the student is a transfer student in their first semester at AU. Graduate students must have a minimum cumulative 3.0 grade point average. Student grades for those in the following positions will be confirmed by CSI: President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requestor.

Students who are ineligible to serve in an executive board position must be replaced by the organization for the organization to proceed through the registration process. If an organization seeking recognition drops below the minimum number of members or officers required at any point in the new club registration process, they must fill those vacancies within 3 business days that the requirement is not met in order to proceed.

Preliminary Requirements for Organizations Seeking Recognition

- The organization seeking recognition must be open to all students, abide by AU's nondiscrimination policies, and be accessible to all AU students.
- Organizations seeking recognition may only be proposed by currently enrolled undergraduate or

graduate students at AU.

- The student proposing the organization will be considered the primary contact and they, along with all executive board members, must currently be a full-time student at American University and must plan to be the primary contact and enrolled in the following semester (Graduate students who plan to graduate following the current semester and notify CSI of the organization's future primary contact may be permitted to proceed). Any student planning to study abroad, take a leave of absence, or otherwise not maintain full-time student status during these specified semesters will not be eligible for Executive Board positions.
- A member of the club's executive board must attend required training sessions offered by CSI (dates are published each semester on Engage).
- A full-time AU faculty/staff advisor.
- A roster of at least 8 members, including a President, Treasurer, Secretary and EMS Requestor. The EMS Requestor position can be held simultaneously with another executive board position. The President and Treasurer positions cannot be held by the same individual. The advisor is not included in the 8-member requirement.
- To be considered for recognition, organizations seeking recognition must be distinct from existing organizations. Organizations seeking recognition bearing any similarity to existing groups will be required to document differences in mission, purpose, and campus impact in their application and presentation. Students looking to start a new club are expected to first review the full list of existing organizations on Engage to ensure that a similar organization does not already exist.
- If the same organization already exists for undergraduates, a new organization can seek recognition for graduate students; conversely, if the organization exists for graduate students, a similar organization can seek recognition for undergraduate students. The mission and purpose of said proposed club should be tailored to meet the needs of that population. Organizations seeking recognition that are seeking to create a duplicate graduate version of an undergraduate club, or vice versa, will need to go through the Club Duplication process, rather than the New Club Registration process.
- CSI governance groups may establish cohort-specific requirements for new club registration; those requirements must be detailed in their Standard Operating Procedures and/or constitutions and will be announced during each iteration of new club registration.

To form a new RSO at AU, you must complete the following steps:

Step 1: Review Recognized Student Organizations at AU

Review Engage for the full list of existing organizations to ensure that your club has a unique mission not yet fulfilled by an existing recognized organization. If your club's mission is already fulfilled by an existing recognized organization, your application will be denied, and you will be encouraged to join said organization. This can be discussed in your initial consultation meeting with CSI.

Note: For any proposed group that is similar to a frozen student organization that is attempting to reactivate, CSI reserves the right to defer or deny the organization seeking recognition, deny the frozen group's application for reactivation, or defer/deny both at any point in the process. To the extent possible, CSI will prioritize connecting students from both groups so that they have the opportunity to consolidate or distinguish efforts. These expectations also apply to multiple organizations seeking recognition that are similar.

Step 2: Initial Consultation Meeting

Set up an initial consultation meeting with CSI to discuss the New Club Registration process and an overview of the University's policies pertaining to recognized student organizations and organizations seeking recognition. You will discuss any similarities to existing organizations, including frozen organizations, so that you have the opportunity to reactivate the frozen group if desired. Only groups that have conducted a consultation meeting are permitted to apply for New Club Registration.

Step 3: Application

Submit an application for your proposed organization by the stated deadline. The application must include:

1. A roster of at least 8 student members, including a President, Treasurer, and EMS Requestor
2. A faculty/staff advisor and their completed advisor acknowledgement
3. An organizational descriptive statement that includes your mission, the phrase "open to all students" and the required nondiscrimination language
4. And additional information that is outlined in this section

Applicants are expected to be aware of this policy, the evaluation rubric, and any similar recognized student organizations in preparing their applications. Organizations seeking recognition bearing any similarity to existing recognized groups will be required to document differences in mission, purpose, and campus impact in their application. Failure to sufficiently document these differences may be grounds for deferral or denial. Organizations seeking recognition that are organized around religious, spiritual, or other beliefs must provide documentation of approval from the Kay Spiritual Life Center to begin the New Club Registration process. Organization application materials must adhere to CSI's openness and inclusion expectations for RSOs, including their Engage page descriptive statements. Once a student group submits the initial application to be considered for new club registration, they are considered an organization seeking recognition and are held to the same policies and expectations of recognized student organizations.

Step 4: Initial Administrative Review

Upon receipt of applications for organizations seeking recognition, CSI staff conduct an initial administrative review. As part of the initial administrative review, CSI will conduct eligibility checks for your organization's executive board, an organizational conduct review, determine if an existing organization already fulfills your organization's mission on campus and ensure that all required elements are included in your organization's application. During the initial administrative review, CSI staff may deny or defer an application for reasons outlined in the Deferrals & Denials section of this policy. Additionally, during the course of the initial administrative review, CSI may also defer or deny any applications that are incomplete or applicants that describe an organization that is identical or very similar to an existing recognized organization at AU. CSI will provide applicants an opportunity to correct simple administrative errors on their application during the initial administrative review; however, errors that are not promptly corrected and persist may be grounds for deferral or denial. Applicants may appeal deferral or denial decisions to the Executive Director, per the process outlined in the Appeals section of this policy.

Step 5: Supporting Documentation

Organizations seeking recognition that receive approval from the administration review will be

required to compile the following supporting documentation:

1. Organizational Plan: Draft a thoughtful organizational plan outlining the organization seeking recognition's short and long-term goals and anticipated challenges; recruitment and officer transition plan; anticipated budget and resource needs; an event and marketing plan; and an overview of any potential safety, financial, risk management, or other concerns and plans to mitigate those risks.
2. Student Interest List: Submit a list of students to CSI who have expressed interest in or support for your organization seeking recognition using the template provided by CSI. This list should include more than the minimum required number of 8 members and will be used to assess the sustainability of your organization's interest and campus impact.
3. Constitution: Submit your organization's constitution, which must be based on the provided CSI constitution template, and schedule a meeting with a CSI staff member to review your organization's club constitution and make any necessary adjustments.
    a. The following are required clauses in all organization constitutions:
        i. *Clause 1:* Membership in a recognized student organization must be open only to AU students and any student must be able to join.
            1. *Note:* the term "registered student organization" is also acceptable.
        ii. *Clause 2: American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual's personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status.*
            1. *Note:* the following iteration is also acceptable: American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, pregnancy or parenting, age, sexual orientation, disability, marital status, personal appearance, gender identity and expression, family responsibilities, political affiliation, source of income, veteran status, an individual's genetic information or any other bases under applicable federal and local laws and regulations (collectively "Protected Bases") in its programs and activities.
        iii. *Clause 3:* Student organizations must abide by all University policies. Student organizations cannot manage, investigate, or address any component of potential Student Conduct or Equity /Title IX violations. Students are encouraged to report these concerns to the appropriate offices.
        iv. *Clause 4:* If a student organization becomes defunct, is no longer recognized, or separates from the university for more than 2 years, the Center for Student Involvement, with approval from the AVP for Student Engagement, may reallocate any remaining fundraised funds to purposes that closely align with the original organization's mission.
    b. Your organization's constitution must also include an introductory statement clearly stating that your organization is open to all in the mission/purpose statement.
    c. All required edits to the constitution must be made to receive final approval by CSI. Organizations seeking recognition are held to the standards outlined in the required clauses.
    d. Chapters affiliated with national/international organizations must be in compliance with all AU policies and procedures. AU policies and procedures supersede the bylaws of any

national/international organization in any areas of conflict between the two sets of requirements. The CSI constitution review meeting is intended, in part, to resolve any discrepancies between AU policies and those of national/international organizations, as needed.

4. Faculty/Staff Advisor Letter of Support: Organizations seeking recognition are required to submit from their faculty or staff advisor a letter of support for their organization. The letter of support must detail the advisor's expertise or interest in the organization's mission statement, the support the advisor plans to provide to the organization and its members, confirmation that the advisor is a full-time faculty or staff member or has received an exemption from this requirement, the advisor's intended level of involvement in the organization, and confirmation that the advisors has submitted the faculty/staff advisor acknowledgement

- Headquarters (HQ) Letter of Support (as applicable): Organizations seeking recognition that are affiliated with a national or international organization must also submit a letter of support from their respective headquarters. The letter of support must detail the support the HQ plans to provide to the organization and its members, as well as address any concerns related to conflicts between AU policy and HQ policies.

Applicants must submit each item required by the policy. CSI staff may follow up with applicants on the materials they submitted to provide feedback and request changes. CSI may defer or deny applications for which materials are missing or incomplete at the deadline or for those who fail to remedy materials by the requested deadline.

Step 6: New Club Committee Presentations

Organizations seeking recognition that satisfy the necessary requirements in Step 5 by the stated deadlines will be invited to present their organization to the New Club Committee. Applicants should prepare a presentation that covers:

- Their initial application (Step 3)
- Their supporting documentation (Step 5), including their organizational structure from the constitution
- Any similarities to other organizations seeking recognition or frozen organizations attempting to reactivate

There will also be time for questions during the presentation.

The New Club Committee is comprised of two AUCC students for undergraduate organizations or two GLC students for graduate organizations, and three CSI staff members: the Assistant Director of Recognized Student Organizations, the Senior Associate Director for Training and Development, and the RSO Graduate Assistant. The Assistant Director of Recognized Student Organization serves as the Chair of the New Club Committee. Specific staff involvement may fluctuate to accommodate staffing needs and may be adjusted by the Senior Associate Director based on the governance group to which the organization seeking recognition may report; for example, the CSI advisor for graduate student organizations may replace another CSI staff member on the committee in the case of a graduate student organization seeking recognition. The committee is responsible for reviewing materials, including initial applications and supporting documentation information, and deciding whether a group satisfies the rubric requirements. CSI manages conducting initial administrative reviews, verification that a group has satisfied

the requirements of this policy, and the hearing of denial appeals (through the Executive Director).

Step 7: New Club Committee Decisions

The rubric below is used by the committee to review and evaluate organizations seeking recognition, their presentation, and materials submitted. The five categories that groups will be evaluated on are their distinct mission, campus impact, student interest, sustainability, and action plan. The rubric is to be used as a tool for committee deliberations and discussions in assessing the qualifications of an organization seeking recognition. Applicants should refer to this rubric to guide the development of their application, supporting documentation, and presentation.

If the Committee has concerns regarding an organization seeking recognition's compliance with items a. through k. outlined in the Deferrals & Denials section, the Committee may refer those concerns to CSI staff who reserve the ability to issue an administrative denial or deferral if warranted. If there are no concerns, however, the Committee may choose to approve, deny or defer applications based on the presentations and materials reviewed. Generally speaking, the Committee will approve organizations seeking recognition that demonstrate strength in their presentation and materials, deny organizations seeking recognition that do not demonstrate sufficient strength in their presentation and materials, or defer organizations that demonstrate some strength in their materials but could benefit from additional time to more fully develop their ideas. The NCR evaluation rubric will be used to support these decisions. Committee decisions are made by a majority vote.

Recognition of student organizations by CSI shall not imply support for any student organization's purpose, philosophy, or activities. The University will not assume legal liabilities for any student organization's activities that have not been previously approved and do not follow University policy.

New Club Registration – Committee Evaluation Rubric				
Category	Criteria	1: Weak	2: Average	3: Strong
Distinct Mission	• Initial application • Mission statement • Organizational Plan • Presentation	• Identical or very similar to existing recognized organization(s) or organization(s) seeking recognition at AU. • Will sponsor redundant activities or encroach on existing activities.	• Visible differences from existing recognized organization(s) or organization(s) seeking recognition, even though some overlap may exist. • Will sponsor activities that do not encroach on existing activities.	• Distinct from all existing recognized organizations and organizations seeking recognition. • Will sponsor distinct activities.
Campus Impact	• Initial application • Organizational Plan • Presentation	• Does not fulfill a need on campus. • Will not add value to the student experience. • University recognition is not necessary to achieve group mission, or impact could be achieved through an existing	• Meets a need on campus. • Will add value to the student experience. • University recognition will help achieve the group's mission.	• Meets a significant need on campus. • Will add significant value to the student experience. • University recognition is necessary to achieve the group's mission.

		organization.		
Student Interest	• Initial application • Student Interest List • Organizational Plan • Presentation	• Student interest beyond the minimum membership requirement is not demonstrated.	• Student interest beyond the minimum membership requirement is demonstrated.	• Student interest is broadly demonstrated.
Sustainability	• Initial application • Student Interest List • Organizational Plan • Presentation	• Purpose will not be relevant or will be obsolete in 2 years. • Membership will decrease after departure of founders. • Requires unrealistic resources from the university (financial, space/facilities, staff support, equipment/technology, etc.)	• Purpose will maintain relevancy in 2 years. • Membership will be sustained after departure of founders. • Resources required are justified based on the value-add or need met.	• Purpose will maintain long-term relevancy. • Membership will grow after departure of founders. • Resources required are justified based on the value-add or need met.
Action Plan	• Initial application • Organizational plan • Presentation	• No goals articulated, or goals are vague or unrealistic • Potential challenges have not been considered. • Fails to anticipate or adequately address potential risks.	• Goals are thoughtful and considered. • Potential challenges have been addressed. • Identifies risks and provides a plan to mitigate them.	• Goals are specific and achievable . • Potential challenges are anticipated and adequately addressed. • Low risk profile

Approved applications refer to groups that the committee has determined has satisfied the rubric and requirements. It is important to note that a favorable committee decision is conditioned on satisfying all requirements, including outstanding requirements, for recognition. Organizations seeking recognition that are approved by the Committee will receive recognition pending their completion of the required training courses and assessments and final verification of satisfying all requirements.

Deferrals & Denials

Organizations seeking recognition must satisfy all criteria for recognition in order to be approved as a recognized student organization. For example, an organization seeking recognition may receive approval to begin the process following the initial administrative review but may later be denied by the New Club Committee based on their presentation and materials. Similarly, an organization seeking recognition may be approved by the New Club Committee but ultimately be denied recognition due to failure to complete the training requirements by the stated deadline. CSI reserves the right to deny or defer an organization seeking recognition.

Denied applications refer to the rejection of the application for recognition of an organization seeking recognition. Organizations seeking recognition that are denied may not reapply for a period of three years.

Deferred applications refer to temporarily delaying the process of officially recognizing a student

organization. An application may be deferred for a period of up to 1 year. An organization's application is placed on a deferred status when an organization needs additional time to meet specific requirements or address any outstanding issues before being reconsidered for recognition. Organizations seeking recognition that are deferred may reapply in the next recognition cycle if they meet all policy requirements, or within the same cycle if CSI determines that there is enough time to complete the process, as applicable.

CSI staff may deny or defer an application at any point in the New Club Registration process, including during the initial administrative review, or the committee deliberation process (such as for failing to satisfy the rubric criteria). Further, an organization's application may be denied or deferred per the criteria outlined below and throughout this policy, including but not limited to the following:

a. The organization's proposed activities would put it in violation of university policy, including prohibited conduct under the Student Conduct Code. Organizations may also be deferred or denied if their proposed activities that may reasonably raise direct or immediate concern for safety or well-being, which would be reviewed in consultation with Enterprise Risk Management.
b. Non-compliance with the RSO Manual or failure to previously abide by CSI expectations for unrecognized groups.
c. The organization's non-cooperation with or failure to meet with the Center for Student Involvement and/or New Club Committee or failure to complete requirements by the stated deadline(s). Applicants must submit each item required by the policy. CSI staff may follow up with applicants on the materials they submitted, to provide feedback and request changes. CSI may defer or deny applications for which materials are missing or incomplete at the deadline or for those who fail to remedy materials by the requested deadline.
d. The organization is not open to all students, violates the university's nondiscrimination policies, or are not accessible to all AU students (however, groups may utilize selection processes as long as they comply with relevant CSI policies)
e. The student proposing the organization is currently not a full-time student at American University
f. The organization is tied to a class or has an academic component required to join
g. The organization operates as a business, for-profit entity, or is looking to generate money from participants
h. The organization is a social fraternity or sorority (contact FSL for information on how to start a new chapter)
i. The organization is a club sport or fitness-based organization (visit RecFit for information about how to get involved)
j. Approval of any organization seeking recognition requires that the organization, including individual applicant(s), as defined in this policy, does not meet any of the following disqualifying criteria: (a) currently subject to sanctions or other actions related to violation(s) of university policy as determined in consultation with the Office of Equity and Title IX and the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices; (b) the organization seeking recognition is currently under investigation by the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices and/or the Dean of Students office for allegations of misconduct under university policy or is under review by one of these offices regarding a climate concern, as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here), (c) the Office of Equity and Title IX has determined that the organization seeking recognition's conduct has created or contributed to (1) a hostile environment or (2) a climate concern, as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here),

within the university community; or (d) the organization's application for recognition has been denied or deferred for the current iteration of new club registration due to an investigation related to an allegation or a finding of misconduct, or a determination of a climate concern, as defined by the Office of Inclusive Excellence (see here), within the university community. The Center for Student Involvement, in consultation with the Office of Equity and Title IX, shall determine whether a denial or deferral of recognition is warranted for organizations seeking recognition under review by any of these offices concerning a climate-related concern, in circumstances where a formal investigation has not been initiated. Students in elected or appointed leadership positions required by CSI (President, Treasurer, EMS Requestor, and Secretary) must be currently enrolled students, in good student conduct standing, with at least a 2.5 (undergraduate) or 3.0 (graduate) GPA to hold these positions. Students who are not in good disciplinary standing with the university are not permitted to serve as a leader in an organization seeking recognition.

Additionally, CSI staff may defer an application for reasons including but not limited to the following:

k. Approval of any organization seeking recognition requires that the Office of Equity and Title IX or the Office of Student Accountability is not currently conducting an investigation, nor has received a credible report alleging violations of university policy by the organization seeking recognition, nor has one of these office received a credible report that the organization seeking recognition's conduct has created or contributed to a hostile environment or other otherwise engaged in a policy violation. If an investigation leads to findings of responsibility related to a policy violation and/or a determination of a climate concern, CSI reserves the right to deny recognition to the organization seeking recognition under Step 7, section j.

Applicants may appeal deferral or denial decisions to the Director per the process outlined in the Appeals section of this policy.

Step 8: Notification

Organizations seeking recognition will be notified of committee decisions by CSI. Organizations seeking recognition that are deferred or denied will receive a rationale based on the evaluation criteria outlined below. Applicants may appeal deferral or denial decisions to the Director per the process outlined in the Appeals section of this policy.

If an organization seeking recognition's application is deferred – and those reasons are not tied to the actions of an individual who is no longer serving as President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requestor at the time of reapplication – then the organization must meet with CSI staff before reapplying within a two-year period. During this meeting, the organization will review the previous deferral and must demonstrate in their new application, supporting materials, and presentation how they have addressed the original reasons for deferral.

If an organization seeking recognition's application is denied – and those reasons are not tied to the actions of an individual who is no longer a serving as President, Treasurer, Secretary, and EMS Requestor at the time of reapplication – then the organization must meet with CSI staff before reapplying within a five-year period. During this meeting, the organization will review the previous denial and must demonstrate in their new application, supporting materials, and presentation how they have addressed the original reasons for denial.

CSI will maintain records of previous decisions. All decisions are documented and maintained in the Engage platform, including the rationale for denial or deferral during each iteration of the NCR process.

Appeals

Organizations seeking recognition may appeal a denial or deferral decision by submitting an appeal letter within 5 business days to the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center. The only decisions that may be appealed are those following the initial administrative review (Step 4) or committee decisions (Step 7). The Executive Director may reverse the initial administrative or committee denial/deferral for the following reasons:

- New information that becomes available that could not have been discovered or disclosed by a reasonably diligent applicant that significantly alters the content or evaluation of the application.
- A specified procedural error that was so substantial that it affected the outcome of the decision.

The Executive Director will make a determination based on the appeal letter and original application. All decisions of the Executive Director are final.

Step 9: Required Trainings and Assessments

Groups that receive Committee approval must then complete all required training courses and submit all required assessments by the stated deadline. Required trainings are the same as those for all active organizations, as referenced on page 13.

Step 10: Final Requirement Completion and Verification

Organizations seeking recognition that satisfy all of the requirements of this policy and that receive approval from the New Club Committee will be approved as new recognized student organizations, effective on the last day of the current semester, pending final verification by the Executive Director. The Executive Director's role here is to verify that organizations seeking recognition that are slated for approval have satisfied all of the requirements of this policy, including a check that Engage pages and constitutions comply with all relevant university policies. Once verification takes place, organizations seeking recognition that have successfully satisfied all requirements will be notified of the official recognition decision. Groups that receive notice of final approval must have their Engage pages fully updated within 5 business days. Fully approved new recognized student organizations are encouraged to meet with CSI and their governance board to support a successful onboarding experience.

Political Activities

These guidelines are meant to jointly recognize AU students' active participation in the political process and AU's institutional obligation, as a non-profit entity, to remain neutral in the political process. All recognized student organizations, regardless of candidate, political party, or political action committee (PAC) affiliation, are prohibited from:

a. Coordinating university fundraising with the fundraising for any candidate for public office, political party, PAC, or any similar politically active organization.
b. Reimbursing AU administrators, faculty, or staff for campaign contributions.
c. Permitting candidates for political office to use AU facilities (including, but not limited to, mailing lists, office space, telephones, copy machines) to support the candidate or a campaign, political party, or PAC.
d. Placing AU registered visual trademarks (logos) on any communications including, but not limited to, mailings, flyers, online, and social media. Any communications must unambiguously convey that messaging is on behalf of individual students or their organization, and not AU. Organizations should include disclaimer language on their Engage profile, website(s), and social media profiles as

follows: “The views expressed herein are purely those of the [RSO’s Name], and its individual members, and do not necessarily represent the views of American University.”

Membership Guidelines

Membership in a recognized student organization must be open only to all AU students, and any student must be able to join. All others- alumni, friends, family, faculty, and staff- are considered guests. Guests cannot hold officer positions, vote in elections, or handle money on behalf of the organization. Furthermore, membership in undergraduate recognized student organizations is open only to undergraduate students; membership in graduate recognized student organizations is open only to graduate students. Graduate students may still attend undergraduate student events, and vice versa, and graduate and undergraduate organizations are encouraged to collaborate with each other. However, internal events, such as practices, group trips, meetings, etc., may be limited to those students eligible for membership in the organization (i.e. undergraduate or graduate students only). Exceptions may be approved by the Executive Director, Student Engagement & Student Center, in instances where the RSO does not utilize student activity fees, or in instances where events hosted by that RSO are open only to a subset of membership that corresponds to the fee being utilized.

Organizations are allowed to set requirements for leadership positions within the organization, as long as they do not conflict with CSI or university policies.

Generally, CSI considers officers and executive board members as the leaders of the organization and members with whom CSI corresponds with, meets with, and views responsible for the organization and its activities. While it is expected that recognized student organizations regularly update their roster to reflect both executive board and general membership, it is possible that students who appear on an organization’s roster may not necessarily be active members of the group. Active members are generally defined by CSI as those who regularly attend events and meetings. However, RSOs are encouraged to define active membership in their constitutions. RSOs must ensure membership, active membership, all related privileges/benefits of active members, and leadership positions are open to all students, unless otherwise stated in this Manual.

Organizations that experience a leadership change (i.e., an officer can no longer fulfill their duties in the middle of their term) must ensure Engage records are updated, the organization’s advisor is informed, and the relevant trainings are completed.

The following are required clauses in all organization constitutions.

- *Clause 1: Membership in a recognized student organization must be open only to AU students and any student must be able to join.*
  - *Note:* the term “registered” is also acceptable to use in this clause.
- *Clause 2: American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual’s personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status.*
  - *Note:* the following iteration can also be used: *American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, pregnancy or parenting, age, sexual orientation, disability, marital status, personal appearance, gender identity and expression, family responsibilities, political affiliation, source of income, veteran status, an individual’s genetic information or any other bases under applicable federal and local laws and regulations (collectively “Protected Bases”) in its programs and activities.*

- *Clause 3: Student organizations must abide by all University policies. Student organizations cannot manage, investigate, or address any component of potential Student Conduct or Equity /Title IX violations. Students are encouraged to report these concerns to the appropriate offices.*
- *Clause 4: If a student organization becomes inactive, is no longer recognized, or separates from the University and there are no active efforts or plans for the organization to return within 2 years, the Center for Student Involvement, with approval from the AVP for Student Engagement, may reallocate any remaining fundraised funds to student organizations that closely align with the original Organization's mission.*

Some organizations have additional requirements for membership; however, they must be outlined in the constitution and cannot supersede the clauses mentioned above. Such organizations include:

- Honor societies and professional fraternities/sororities- requirements such as GPA and major from the national organization are allowed, as long as such requirements are listed specifically in the national headquarters' own membership requirements and clearly stated in the organization constitution. Any professional fraternity/sorority or honor society organization that has a recruitment and/or new member process is required to meet with CSI prior to engaging in those processes.
- Performing arts and competitive groups- all groups must be open to **all** students; however, such organizations can include requirements for participating in performances (i.e., auditions for shows), as well as limit internal events such as practices to members only. These groups are encouraged to outline the difference between the rights and responsibilities of general membership and performers/competitors.
- RSOs that are exempt from Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, relating to discrimination on the basis of gender, including Fraternity & Sorority organizations.
- RSOs that are organized around representation of specific colleges or schools at the University, including membership based on college enrollment or class standing.
- Belief-based RSOs, including religious student organizations, which may limit membership or leadership positions to those who share the same beliefs or practices, as well as political or ideological groups, which may be permitted to limit membership to individual who support the group's mission or agree to operate in good faith.

RSOs are permitted to establish membership requirements or expectations, subsets of organizational membership, and member removal processes, so long as those requirements do not violate the university's nondiscrimination policies, are directly connected to their mission, documented in their constitution, and are processes (such as auditions or tryouts) that are open to all:

- RSOs are permitted to establish membership requirements or expectations, such as those related to talent, individual merit, performance needs, GPA, experience, interests, skills, or requirements to uphold the organizations' mission,
- Certain subsets of organizational membership activities may not be open to all students. For example, E-Board meetings or group practices are not required to be open to all students. Beyond the circumstances outlined above, groups requesting selective membership must receive approval from the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center. Prior approvals will be reviewed regularly.
- Members of recognized student organizations are expected to support the organization's mission and not disrupt organizational business. Recognized student organization constitutions may include

conditions for removal of a member from the organization. However, these must be tied to attendance, requirements, mandatory events, member responsibilities, or one or more of the criteria listed above; may not violate university policies; and must also include an appeals process. Additionally, RSOs are required to notify CSI within 5 business days of removing a member. This does not apply to instances in which an officer is removed but still remains a member of the organization. Student organizations cannot manage, investigate, or address any component of potential Student Conduct or Equity /Title IX violations or remove or take any action against an individual for alleged violations of university policy. Students are encouraged to report these concerns to the appropriate offices.

Openness & Inclusion Expectations

Recognized student organizations' descriptive statements, including but not limited to organizational descriptions on Engage pages, constitution mission/purpose statements, and marketing materials, must invite the participation of all students who are interested in the organization's mission/purpose/goals. The description should make a first-time student feel welcome to participate in your organization. See below for examples. *Note:* While the Membership Guidelines above detail examples of when an organization may establish additional requirements for membership, those requirements may not be based on protected class. For purposes of these examples, assume that "Cobalt" and "Crimson" are made-up personal characteristics.

Meets Standard:

- Cobalt Success Society: The Cobalt Success Society ("CSS") is an organization dedicated to fostering and advocating for the visibility of Cobalt students on campus. CSS seeks to strengthen the presence of Cobalt students through the creation of a community of Cobalt and non-Cobalt students dedicated to supporting, uplifting, and encouraging Cobalt voices.
- Crimson Connect: Crimson Connect serves as a safe space at AU for Crimson-identifying students while embracing individuals of all backgrounds who are committed to allyship and advocacy. Our organization's purpose is to coalesce members of the AU community who seek to empower and inspire Crimson students. Crimson Connect's goals include educating the AU community about issues affecting Crimson students and proposing actionable solutions.

Does not meet Standard:

- Cobalt Students United: Cobalt Students United ("CSU") serves Cobalt students at AU. CSU's purpose and mission are to support Cobalt-identifying students and create a network of Cobalt students. CSU's goals include connecting Cobalt students to scholarships and job opportunities.
- Crimson Academic Alliance: The Crimson Academic Alliance ("CAA") is a community of Crimson students. CAA provides a space for Crimson students to exchange course notes, connect with faculty mentors, apply for research grants, and more. CAA's goals include creating opportunities for and fostering connections with our AU Crimson peers.

Additionally, please note the following:

- RSO online platforms, including but not limited to their Engage accounts, must clearly include the following:
    - A statement that the organization/event is "*open to all students.*"
    - The following nondiscrimination statement: *American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual's personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared*

ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status.

- In addition to the above required statements, all flyers and Engage advertisements for organization sponsored activities must also state the following:
    - "*For reasonable accommodations needs or requests, please contact Maura Fox at mfox@american.edu."*
    - *Note:* Groups may elect to link their advertisements, via web link or QR code, to university or RSO policy resources related to these openness and inclusion expectations.
- Flyers and Engage event submissions that do not meet the above expectations will be denied. There may be reasonable instances in which the inclusion of any of the above required phrases would not be appropriate, such as advertisements/Engage events for E-Board meetings and team practices.
- Your organization's current constitutions and bylaws must be readily apparent and include the non-discrimination statement and introductory statement clearly stating your organization is open to all. Obsolete versions of past constitutions will need to be clearly labeled as such or archived.
- For additional resources on how to make your event accessible, check out the Office of Inclusive Excellence's guidelines: Making Events Accessible Updated Feb 2026.

CSI staff regularly review and approve Engage event submissions and will review these items during the course of regular review. CSI and Mary Graydon Student Center will also review these items when conducting flyer approvals. Concerns regarding flyer and/or Engage event descriptions may be referred to the Center for Student Involvement for follow up via the Recognized Student Organization Accountability Process. Any potential violations of the University Posted Materials Policy may be referred to the Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices.

Faculty/Staff Advisor

All RSOs must have a full-time AU faculty or staff member serving as their advisor. Advisors mentor student leaders, support the organization's development, and ensure awareness of university policies. Advisors are annually required to complete an advisor acknowledgement during their tenure as an advisor. To access the acknowledgement on Engage, click here.

Section 1: CSI Faculty/Staff Advisor Support

The Center for Student Involvement (CSI) is responsible for:

- Providing advisement, oversight, and recognition for all RSOs within the Division of Student Affairs.
- Supporting and collaborating with Faculty and Staff Advisors on RSO advising, finances, event planning, leadership development and understanding of university policies.
- Assisting advisors and RSOs with organizational concerns and issues.
- Establishing policies and procedures for involvement opportunities through student-led recognized student organizations (RSOs).

Section 2: General Expectations

- The Faculty and Staff Advisors role is voluntary, unless it is otherwise outlined in your job description. Advisors are selected by student leaders, and role responsibilities and expectations should be mutually established and aligned with the Advisor Acknowledgement, RSO constitution, and RSO Manual.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors are not required to advise a specific RSO and do not receive financial or other compensation for serving in this role. For faculty members whose responsibilities include service, advising an RSO may count toward their service contributions.
- As part of the renewal process, RSOs must include their advisor contact information. This information is listed on our student engagement platform as part of the RSO's roster information and is visible to the AU community.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors must be full-time university employees. Exceptions may be granted on limited occasions, and on a case-by-case basis for part-time faculty and AU staff at the discretion of the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors may choose to step down from their role at any time. Given this is a recognition requirement for RSOs, advisors are asked to notify the RSO and CSI in writing as soon as possible to support transition. Student leaders may also choose a new advisor as needed and are expected to communicate with CSI and the current advisor in writing about any potential changes.
- CSI reserves the right to remove an advisor for violations of the RSO Manual, failure to uphold this acknowledgement, willful misconduct, or gross negligence.
- The primary role of the advisor is to provide guidance. RSOs are student-run organizations, and it is important to engage with the organization in a way that balances student autonomy with responsible advising. Advisors are not responsible for doing administrative work or making decisions for student leaders. **Advisors are not permitted to sign forms or contracts on behalf of the RSO.**
- CSI and Faculty and Staff Advisors have a joint responsibility to maintain communication and awareness about changes to the RSO Manual and relevant university policies. CSI must alert advisors about these changes, and advisors must review in a timely manner.

Section 3: Organization Support and Engagement

- Faculty and Staff Advisors should be available to meet at least once a semester ~~,~~ with RSO student leaders, or more frequently as determined in consultation with them.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should be available to support the organization's development, mentor student leaders, and help in facilitating students' understanding of relevant university policies.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should be familiar with the organization's purpose, its constitution, and goals through meetings and interactions with student leadership.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should maintain communication with their RSO about organizational activities, including upcoming events and programs through email or check-in meetings and follow up as needed.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should assist their organization through the transition of leadership, which could include elections, onboarding of new officers, or sharing university resources.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should serve as advocates for the organization and make CSI aware of concerns that raise obstacles for the RSO.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should maintain timely and professional communication with the RSO and CSI. Advisors may occasionally receive inquiries from other offices or departments related to the RSO they advise; CSI can assist with responses as needed. RSOs are likewise expected to respond promptly and professionally to communications from their advisor and CSI.

Section 4: Safety and Risk Management

- Faculty and Staff Advisors must participate in an annual advisor information session hosted by CSI.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors must review information about Clery responsibilities annually coordinated by the American University Police Department.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors must review the university's hazing prevention information at least once while serving as an advisor.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors should provide event planning guidance, as needed, to RSOs by directing them to CSI, clarifying policy, and consulting with CSI when necessary.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors may be asked to collaborate with CSI on select events, such as those with safety considerations (ex: events that require waivers, significant attendance and event size considerations, safety assessments or, AUPD services and support) or special guests (dignitaries, diplomats, government officials, or other public figures/celebrities). Advisors are also encouraged to participate in complex event meetings as appropriate.
- If an advisor becomes aware of an organization's violation of university policy, they are required to report violations including but not limited to, the Discrimination and Non-Title IX Sexual Misconduct Policy, the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy, the Student Conduct Code, and the Clery Act to the appropriate office.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors are expected to provide guidance and suggest alternative approaches if they believe an RSO is planning or engaging in activities that may violate university policy, be illegal, or present safety or compliance concerns.
- Faculty and Staff Advisors are not expected to proactively report student expression, protest, or dissent. However, if an advisor becomes aware of behavior that poses a direct threat to safety or violates university policy, they should consult CSI or the appropriate campus office. Importantly,

advisors who become aware of situations involving a crime, threat to safety, or imminent danger are expected to contact AUPD at 202-885-3636.

Section 5: Specialty RSO Advising

- Certain cohorts under CSI may require additional content expertise (e.g. Student Media and Fraternity & Sorority Life). Advisors to any organization recognized under the Student Media Board and Fraternity and Sorority Life agree that they have received, reviewed, and will abide by the expectations outlined in the Student Media Standard Operating Procedures and the Fraternity and Sorority Life related supporting documents found in the RSO Manual.
- **Advisors for specifically any organization recognized under the Student Media Board must have experience in the content area.**

Organization Events and Programming

One of the ways RSOs contribute to the student experience on campus is by hosting events and programs that engage the campus community. Organizations must follow all CSI procedures to ensure successful programming, such as:

- Only recognized student organizations can serve as a host or advertise events on Engage.
  - A **host** is referred to as the primary RSO responsible for planning, organizing, and executing an event or activity.
- All RSO events, regardless of funding, must be posted on Engage and have attendance taken. Recognized student organizations may not advertise an event, including via social media, until it is approved on Engage.
- Engage flyers and event language can only list the recognized host or cohosts. RSO event advertising must also include the time, location, and hosting organization in their announcements and flyers.
  - *Note:* Unrecognized student organizations and organizations seeking recognition are not eligible to serve as a host, co-host, sponsor or co-sponsor of an event. This includes events hosted, co-hosted, sponsored, or co-sponsored by a recognized student organization, university department, or other university event. These groups also may not be referenced as such in a reservation, marketing and promotional materials, or other materials related to the event.
- RSOs are required to take attendance at all events by reserving CSI card swipers and swiping students into their events using their phones/computers and student AUIDs. The purpose of recording event attendance is to measure campus-wide student engagement trends, support student organization budgets, and collect post-event feedback from participants. RSOs can reserve card swipers via this form.
  - *Note:* If CSI is closed, back up swipers can be checked out at the MGSC Info Desk while the desk is staffed and open.
- Funded events, or those that take place in university facilities, should clearly have in view an audience predominantly composed of members of the University community. In cases of collaborations with external organizations or other campuses, RSOs must maintain attendance outside of Engage for non-AU participants to help ensure funds are spent primarily in benefit of AU community members. Events are considered student organization events when the planning, funding and execution of the event is managed by the student organization. While student organizations can collaborate with university departments, student activity fee money cannot be used to fund departmental events, unless those events are co-sponsored by a recognized student organization or are approved through the Student Engagement Impact Fund process. All events sponsored, co-sponsored, hosted, co-hosted, promoted, or co-promoted by RSOs must follow CSI event policies.
- CSI reserves the right to cancel events that do not adhere to appropriate timelines or violate any university policies, including policies outlined in this manual.
- **A/V**- If you are looking for additional features that are not built into your reserved event space, you can fill out an *A/V Service Request Form*. This must be completed **at least 24 hours in advance of your event, or by 5PM on Thursday if it is a weekend event.**
- RSO programming ends on the last day of classes. During the period of final exams, CSI will make limited exceptions for study breaks and religious observances. Please see the full policy here. With

that, CSI does not fund or manage any RSO events, programs, or travel taking place during the summer term. Requests for space, funding, and travel will be denied. Limited exceptions may be approved by the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center or their designee.

Safety & Risk Management

In order to ensure the safety and well-being of all students, RSOs should be aware of the following:

- Food consumption competitions are not permitted. This includes eating contests, such as races to see who can eat the most food in a limited time or consume spicy food competitively. Reasonable exceptions may be approved by the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center.
- Fire pits, candles, materials or devices that utilize an open flame, and other similar hazardous materials are prohibited.
- Student organizations must work with CSI to obtain and complete certain waivers based on the type of event they are hosting.
    - Assumption of Risk and Release of Liability waivers are needed for higher risk activities and activities with minors. Such higher risk activities include, but are not limited to, bounce houses, pie-in-the face events, dunk tanks, slip and slides, sports or other physical activities, use of vehicles, equipment or hazardous materials, overnight activities/trips, camps, events with animals, and activities which present a potential danger to the participant or others. Waivers help to make sure folks are aware of potential risks and agree to AU policies and procedures. here. It is the organization's responsibility to ensure all participants complete a waiver for the activity before they participate in said activity. Completed waivers must be returned to CSI no later than one business day after the event.
    - If RSOs are participating in off-campus travel outside of the "DMV" (Washington Metropolitan area), participants must sign the student travel waiver available on CSI's Resource Hub. Completed waivers must be submitted by the last business day prior to the travel date.
    - *Note:* CSI works with the Office of Risk Management on certain events or activities that need a custom waiver beyond the standard waiver used. Types of events that may require a custom waiver are snorkeling, SCUBA diving, and zip lining, to name a few.
- The American University Police Department provides security planning and police services, such as escorts for VIP visitors, for special events on American University property. Student organizations requiring special event security arrangements (see Complex Event Policy on page 42) must submit a request at least two weeks in advance of the event using this form. AUPD may follow up on your submission and ask you to complete an event questionairre.

University Religious Observances

When planning organization events, keep in mind religious and cultural holidays and how they might affect your programming or students and community members. A list of AU's observances for the 2026-2027 academic year can be found here.

Complex Events

Complex events are any events that require one or more of the criteria listed below. **All complex events require a meeting with a CSI Advisor prior to the event occurring. Contracted services**- catering, speakers, venues or services that have terms and conditions or require a contract or service agreement

that needs to be signed. This **excludes** speakers that do not require payment.

- **External vendors-** any service or vendor that is not an AU service and is coming to campus from an off-campus 3rd party vendor. This includes **catering over $750 from external vendors that are not considered university approved caterers** (*see catering section*)
- **Hosted outdoors-** events hosted outside on campus (i.e., on the Quad, in the Amphitheater, or Hall of Science plaza)
    - *Note: Y*ou will need to complete a 2Fix request for electricity and/or water to be provided at a cost. You should also request trash and recycling bins to be provided, which is at no cost to you. Requests for services need to be discussed during complex event meetings**.** More details, including instructions for submitting a request, can be found in the How to Work with 2 Fix Guidelines. When completing the forms, include that you are a CSI organization and only require a quote for our approval. Once approved, CSI Finance will work with 2Fix to confirm the service and provide payment details.
- **Off-campus travel outside of the DMV** (Washington Metropolitan area)
- **Safety considerations** – events that require waivers, safety assessments, or AUPD services and support.
    - *Note:* RSOs may be required to submit the **Special Event Request Form** for events with the following circumstance: invited external or guest speakers; non-AU guests; dignitaries, diplomats, government officials, or other public figures/celebrities; if there is a request for medics/EMS or security on-site; if alcohol will be present at the event; events with non-AU guests; event with a large expected attendance (100+ attendees); or if an event requires a safety assessment. This needs to be submitted **at least 2 weeks in advance**. AUPD may follow up on your submission and ask you to complete an event questionairre. The University, through AUPD or University Risk Management, may be required to conduct a safety assessment for any events that raise reasonable safety concerns. Similarly, the University may limit or restrict events where there are reasonable concerns around potential violations of university policy or a concern for individual or community safety until those concerns can be addressed through collaboration between CSI and the event host.
- **Special guests** – hosting dignitaries, diplomats, government officials, or other public figures/celebrities
- **Events with Minors** – activities and programs in which Minors (any person under the age of eighteen (18)) will be physically present and participating as defined in AU's Children on Campus and Working with Minors Policy. CSI works with the Office of Risk Management to vet proposed events with minors, and CSI reserves the right to deny a proposed event due to the event's scale or scope, the absence of an AU unit or external organization willing to support the event, or resources required to adequately meet the requirements of the Children on Campus and Working with Minors Policy. RSOs are required to contact their CSI advisor if they are interested in hosting potential activities with participation from minors.
- **Events with non-AU guests** – events where organizers anticipate, expect, or invite the attendance of individuals from outside of the AU community
- **100+ expected attendees** - events that expect over 100 attendees or have over 100 attendees registered on Engage

Due to the extensive planning required for complex events, **all RSOs must follow the timeline** set forth by CSI. If requests do not follow the timeline, they will be rescheduled or denied. Case by case exceptions to

event timelines may be approved by the Senior Associate Director for instances in which an organization is programming around an unforeseen current event, for example.

The complex event timeline is as follows:

Step 1: Complex Event Planning Meeting

- *5-6 weeks prior*
- Meet with your CSI Advisor and the building staff member (if event is on campus) to begin discussing logistics, including any questions, concerns, event options, etc.
    - CSI Advisors: CSI Advisor Assignments.xlsx
    - If your organization is recognized under AUCC (undergraduate), you should also meet with your AUCC Club Consultant: AUCC Club Consultant Assignments

Step 2 *(if on-campus)*: Room Reservation

- *4-5 weeks prior*
- ***EMS Spaces:*** If your event is on campus (including Constitution Hall*), reserve your space on EMS, AU's online space scheduling platform.
    - All organizations can have **one EMS representative** to make space requests. To receive access, fill out the *WebApp Requestor Access Form*.
    - Follow up with your reservation confirmation email to schedule a meeting with the Mary Graydon Student Center staff (eventscheduling@american.edu) to go over space-specific logistics and requests. This is **required** to confirm your space reservation.
        - Tables and chairs can be requested on EMS and are available through the Mary Graydon Student Center. Please be sure to submit your request when reserving the space on EMS.
        - ***2Fix****:* If your event is outside and you need electricity or extra trash cans, be sure to submit a 2Fix request **no later than 1 week prior to your event**. Payment may be required, which you will need to include in your budget & purchase requests.
- ***Non-EMS Spaces (WCL & Katzen):***
    - Washington College of Law*- email WCL Conference & Event Services at roomrentals@wcl.american.edu
    - Katzen*- contact the Facilities Manager at 202-885-3884

*Requires payment for use and is therefore considered a complex purchase; these spaces **cannot** be reserved for a simple event.

Step 3: Engage Event Submission

- *3 weeks prior*
- *Events funded with student activity fee money must be added to the Engage calendar and attendance must be taken through Engage for the event.*
- Submit your event on Engage for review with:
  1) Space Reservation Number (if on campus)
  2) Guest Speaker Consent Form (if needed)
  This must be reviewed and approved by the CSI Advisor of the organization. It states that speakers will follow and respect AU speaker guidelines. When submitting an event on Engage, organizations can upload a copy of the Guest Speaker Consent Form with the speaker's signature and event details. Otherwise, a completed and signed form must be submitted to CSI **at least two weeks** prior to the event. Agreements **cannot** be accepted if there are edits, such as cross-outs and additions*. This

agreement should be signed for all events with non-AU guest speakers, including presentations, and workshops.

*If in the event the speaker does not agree with the terms of this form, the organization can connect the guest speaker with CSI's Finance department to send proposed changes to AU's Procurements and Contracts Office.

3) Openness and Inclusion Expectations

All Engage event descriptions must include the following phrases:

- "Open to all students."
- "American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual's personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status."
- "For reasonable accommodations needs or requests, please contact Maura Fox at mfox@american.edu."

4) Post-event survey

Engage includes a feature that will automatically send out a survey to all your guests at the conclusion of your event. These surveys are helpful for your organization to determine if the event was a success and can be repeated in the future, or if there are areas of improvement. **Include the following questions:**

1. This program/activity was worth my time.
    a. Strongly Disagree
    b. Disagree
    c. Neutral
    d. Agree
    e. Strongly Agree
2. This program/activity treated me like I belong at AU.
    a. Strongly Disagree
    b. Disagree
    c. Neutral
    d. Agree
    e. Strongly Agree
3. How satisfied are you with this program/activity?
    a. Very Dissatisfied
    b. Dissatisfied
    c. Neutral
    d. Satisfied
    e. Very satisfied
4. Event Rating *(automatic)*
5. Comments *(automatic)*

You will receive a notification via Engage regarding the approval or denial of your submission, as revisions may be required. For any questions about the event submission request, reach out to the CSI Graduate Assistant: rsograd@american.edu

Step 4 *(if recognized under AUCC or GLC):* Engage Budget Request Submission

- *4 weeks prior*
- Submit your budget request on Engage for AUCC review **no later than 24 hours prior to AUCC's weekly**

allocation meeting.
    - Please refer to *AUCC's Budget Request Guide* for step-by-step instructions. If the instructions aren't followed, your budget request will be **denied**.
- Requests are reviewed by AUCC twice per week so the **4 weeks must be from the respective weekly** allocation meeting.
    - A member of the CSI Finance team will be present at the AUCC allocation meetings.

Step 5: CSI Purchase Request Submission

- *3 weeks prior*
- Submit your purchase request on Engage for Finance Department Review
    - Please refer to the *Purchase Request Submission Guide* for step-by-step instructions. If the instructions aren't followed, your purchase request will be **denied**.
- **If approved**: An email of approval with further instructions will be sent to the person who submitted the request.
- **If denied**: End of process. You can follow up with your CSI Advisor for alternatives.
- Keep track of your Purchase Request status by checking on the Finance page of your organization.

Please note that all funds not spent within the appropriate timelines will be reallocated back to AUCC for redistribution.

Step 6: Final Logistics

- *1 week prior*
- Make sure the Purchase Request(s) was/were approved, and your order has been processed. For any questions, reach out directly to the CSI Finance team:
    - Luz Torres-Patterson, CSI Assistant Director of Finance & Operations, *luzp@american.edu*
    - Marcus McNeil, CSI Finance Coordinator, *mmcneil@american.edu*
- Keep in touch with your off-campus venue in case they experience any issues.
- For any questions about on-campus room reservations, reach out to your event space directly. We recommend you include your CSI advisor in the email for their awareness.
    - Constitution, *conferences@american.edu*
    - Katzen, *katzenscheduling@american.edu*
    - Kogod, *ksbmeetingspace@american.edu*
    - SIS, *jbanks@american.edu*
    - Mary Graydon Student Center, *eventscheduling@american.edu*
    - WCL, *roomrentals@wcl.american.edu*
    - Athletics, *nfelizsantos@american.edu*
    - *Other Scheduling Offices*

Step 7: Track Attendance

- *At event*
- You can track attendance by using a card swiper or QR code. When guests check in, they will automatically receive an email after the event to review and provide feedback.
    - To reserve a card swiper, fill out this form on Engage.
    - To use the Engage-generated QR code, go to the "Event Details" page to access it and share via a presentation and/or printout.

Step 8: Survey Results

- *24-48 hours post-event*

- View your event's ratings and feedback from the Event Evaluation Questions that were sent to your guests. This will help determine the success of your event and whether it can be improved in the future.

Step 9: Confirm Event Finances

- *24-48 hours post-event*
- For complex events that include a paid service, the CSI Finance team needs confirmation that the event took place in order to process payment for your vendor(s). Reach out to CSI Finance and verify that they have accurate financial information for the vendor.
    - Luz Torres-Patterson, CSI Assistant Director of Finance & Operations, *luzp@american.edu*
    - Marcus McNeil, CSI Finance Coordinator, *mmcneil@american.edu*

Simple Events

Simple events do not meet any of the complex event criteria. These events generally take place on campus or within the local DMV area and should only utilize simple vendors. Some examples include but are not limited to, Chipotle, Panera, Target, and Amazon. Food purchases for simple events with a total food service cost of **$750 or less** may be purchased through these vendors in accordance with University purchasing procedures. If the total food service cost is **$751 or more**, the organization **must use an American University Approved Caterer** unless an exception has been approved in accordance with the University's Food Services Policy. Restaurants that can be found on websites such as EZ Cater are also considered simple. Examples of simple events include trivia nights, general body meetings, teach-ins, dialogue circles, watch parties, and crafting sessions. Simple events also include non-events.

The simple event timeline is as follows:

Step 1: EMS Room Reservation

- *3-4 weeks prior*
- Reserve your space on EMS, AU's online space scheduling platform.
    - All organizations can have **one EMS representative** to make space requests. To receive access, fill out the *WebApp Requestor Access Form*.

Step 2: Engage Event Submission

- *3 weeks prior*
- *Events funded with student activity fee money must be added to the Engage calendar and attendance must be taken through Engage for the event.*
- Submit your event on Engage for review with:

  1) EMS Reservation Number

  2) Openness and Inclusion Expectations

  All events posted on Engage must include the following phrases:
    - "Open to all students."
    - American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual's personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status."
    - "For reasonable accommodations needs or requests, please contact Maura Fox at mfox@american.edu."

  3) Post-event survey

  Engage includes a feature that will automatically send out a survey to all your guests at the conclusion

of your event. These surveys are helpful for your organization to determine if the event was a success and can be repeated in the future, or if there are areas of improvement. **Include the following questions:**

1. This program/activity was worth my time.
    a. Strongly Disagree
    b. Disagree
    c. Neutral
    d. Agree
    e. Strongly Agree
2. This program/activity treated me like I belong at AU.
    a. Strongly Disagree
    b. Disagree
    c. Neutral
    d. Agree
    e. Strongly Agree
3. How satisfied are you with this program/activity?
    a. Very Dissatisfied
    b. Dissatisfied
    c. Neutral
    d. Satisfied
    e. Very satisfied
4. Event Rating *(automatic)*
5. Comments *(automatic)*

You will receive a notification via Engage regarding the approval or denial of your submission, as revisions may be required. For any questions about the event submission request, reach out to the CSI Graduate Assistant: rsograd@american.edu

Step 4 *(if recognized under AUCC or GLC):* Engage Budget Request Submission

- *2 weeks prior*
- Submit your budget request on Engage for AUCC (undergraduate organizations) or GLC (graduate organizations review.
- If your budget request is approved and the funds are allocated, you can submit a purchase request.

Step 4: CSI Purchase Request Submission

- *2 weeks prior*
    - *Please note, that you may not submit a Purchase Request prior to approval of a Budget Request; for example, if your Budget Request is submitted exactly at the two week mark, your following Purchase Request will be out of timeline.*
- Submit your purchase request on Engage for Finance Department Review
    - Please refer to the *Purchase Request Submission Guide* for step-by-step instructions. If the instructions aren't followed, your budget request will be **denied**.
- **If approved**: An email of approval with further instructions will be sent to the person who submitted the request.
- **If denied**: End of process. You can follow up with your CSI Advisor for alternatives.
- Keep track of your Purchase Request status by checking on the Finance page of your organization.

Please note that all funds not spent within the appropriate timelines will be reallocated back to AUCC for redistribution.

Step 5: Final Logistics

- *1 week prior*
- Make sure any Purchase Request(s) was/were approved, and your order has been processed. For any questions, reach out directly to the CSI Finance team:
    - Luz Torres-Patterson, CSI Assistant Director of Finance & Operations, *luzp@american.edu*
    - Marcus McNeil, CSI Finance Coordinator, *mmcneil@american.edu*
- For any questions about room reservations, reach out to your event space using the contact information in your EMS space confirmation email.

Step 6: Track Attendance

- *At event*
- You can track attendance by using a card swiper or QR code. When guests check in, they will automatically receive an email after the event to review and provide feedback.
    - To reserve a card swiper, fill out this form on Engage.
    - To use the Engage-generated QR code, go to the "Event Details" page to access it and share via a presentation and/or printout.

Step 7: Survey Results

- *24-48 hours post-event*
- View your event's ratings and feedback from the Event Evaluation Questions that were sent to your guests. This will help determine the success of your event and whether it can be improved in the future.

Note: CSI and AUCC will implement an annual Budget Request process in the Spring 2027 semester in advance of the 2027-2028 academic year, to support an annual allocations process for RSOs. RSOs will still be able to request funding throughout the year through the existing Budget Request process.

Co-Sponsorships

Co-sponsorships are considered a partnership between two or more recognized student organizations or an organization and a university department where each party shares responsibility for planning, funding, and/or executing an event or activity. More information about co-sponsorships can be found in the Finance Manual.

Recognized Student Organization Accountability and Resolution Procedure

Purpose: Recognized Student Organizations are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that fosters and ensures a positive and respectful relationship within the University and beyond. The below information outlines the procedures that CSI will use to address complaints or concerns about the conduct of a RSO or their responsibilities under this manual that requires remediation to maintain a positive and respectful campus environment. CSI will typically address these matters through educational interventions, corrective measures, and collaborative efforts to ensure compliance and improvement. RSOs are encouraged to view this process as an opportunity to learn and enhance their contributions to the campus community.

Reporting Process

1. Complaints or concerns about the conduct of a RSO or their responsibilities under this manual can be submitted informally here.
2. The Office of Student Accountability and Restorative Practices (OSARP) may refer concerns to the RSO Accountability and Resolution procedure for educational follow up and resolution through this process.

Resolution Process

1. A CSI administrator conducts an initial review to determine the nature and extent of the complaint or concern.
2. If the reported action is an alleged violation of the Student Conduct Code, the Discrimination and Non-Title IX Sexual Misconduct Policy, or the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy, the matter will be referred to OSARP or the Office of Equity and Title IX, depending on the nature of the report, for review.
    a. In some instances, OSARP may determine that an informal resolution or educational follow-up may be appropriate, and it will be conducted by CSI staff. Otherwise, OSARP will follow procedures outlined in the Student Conduct Code regarding adjudicating student organizational misconduct.
3. For all instances in which the reported behavior does not potentially meet the definition of Prohibited Conduct under the Student Conduct Code, the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy, or the Discrimination and Non-Title IX Sexual Misconduct Policy, the following steps apply:
    a. The CSI administrator may determine, after an initial administrative review of the concern, that no follow up or action is needed, and the concern may be dismissed and closed.
    b. The CSI administrator will notify the RSO's leadership in writing within 7 days of receiving notification and schedule a time to meet to discuss the matter.
    c. Based on the collected information, the CSI administrator will determine the nature, extent, and severity of the concern, as appropriate. The RSO will work collaboratively with the CSI administrator to develop an action plan to address the concerning conduct and prevent future occurrences.
    d. The action plan may include required educational interventions, mediation, work with campus partners, attendance at educational workshops, training, constitution reviews, or other appropriate measures.

e. The RSO must implement the action plan within any agreed timeframe.

f. The CSI administrator will monitor the RSO's progress and provide support as needed. At the time of completion, the administration will review the status of the action plan and update or close out as appropriate.

g. If the CSI administrator determines that the RSO has failed to comply with the action plan or participate in this process as outlined above, escalated actions may be taken including potential disciplinary measures under the Student Conduct Code.

Recordkeeping

Issues resolved through this process are not considered formal disciplinary records for recognized student organizations; however, they can be considered by OSARP or other offices when determining a course of action for addressing prohibited conduct outlined in the Student Conduct Code.

For questions or concerns about this procedure, please contact Matthew Galewski, Sr. Associate Director for Training & Development in CSI at mgalewski@american.edu

University Policies

All RSOs must abide by the policies enacted by the University. These include but are not limited to:

- **Non-Discrimination Clause** (*required in all RSO Constitutions):* American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership or benefits on the basis of any individual's personal identity or characteristics, including but not limited to race, color, national origin (or shared ancestry), religion, sex, age, sexual orientation, disability, or veteran status.
    - *Note that the following version of the non-discrimination clause is also acceptable:* American University student organizations shall not discriminate in membership on the basis of race, color, national origin, religion, sex, pregnancy or parenting, age, sexual orientation, disability, marital status, personal appearance, gender identity and expression, family responsibilities, political affiliation, source of income, veteran status, an individual's genetic information or any other bases under applicable federal and local laws and regulations (collectively "Protected Bases") in its programs and activities.
- *Student Conduct Code:* This Student Conduct Code is designed to support a safe, honest, and inclusive community with a shared commitment to acting with mutual respect and forming the highest standards of ethics and morals among its members.
- *Discrimination and Non-Title IX Sexual Misconduct:* This policy addresses the procedures for reporting and responding to incidents of discrimination, harassment, and sexual misconduct that falls outside the scope or jurisdiction of the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy. This Policy is intended to be consistent with applicable local and federal laws and regulations.
- *Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy:* It is the responsibility of every member of the AU Community to foster an environment free of Title IX Sexual Harassment. All members of the AU Community are encouraged to take reasonable and prudent actions to prevent or stop an act of Title IX Sexual Harassment. Taking action may include direct intervention when safe to do so, enlisting the assistance of friends, contacting law enforcement, or seeking assistance from a person in authority.
- *Hazing Policy:* The Hazing Policy defines and prohibits hazing on and off campus and covers groups, clubs, RSOs, teams, and all members of the American University community.
- *Event Limitations During Final Exams:* Recognized student organization programming ends on the last day of classes each semester.
- *Freedom of Expression and Expressive Conduct:* Expression that violates law or University policy, threatens the health and physical safety of others, or disrupts classes, operations, or University-sponsored events is not protected.
- *Alcohol Service at University Events:* ***Undergraduate organizations are not authorized to host events where alcohol will be served.*** If graduate-level groups are interested in hosting an event at a venue that sells alcohol, they must follow the appropriate procedures listed in the document linked above and must work with CSI to ensure all protocols are understood and followed, such as obtaining an alcohol clearance form and the appropriate proof of vendor insurance in addition to the contract.
- *Non-Endorsement of Political Candidates:* Students, staff, and faculty cannot engage in lobbying and political activities on behalf of the University. This policy is not intended to hinder an AU community member's personal expression of political views made in a person's individual capacity and on his/her personal time. However, when engaged in such personal activities, AU community members

must indicate by their words and actions that these activities or expressions are personal positions and are not made on behalf of American University.

- *Prohibited Items & Decorations:* Organizations must avoid using decorations such as latex balloons, glitter, and scotch tape, due to allergy and damage concerns. A list of approved decorations can be found in the link above.
- **American University Space Policies**
    - Washington College of Law
    - SIS
    - East Campus (Constitution and Duber Hall)
        - Constitution Hall Checklist
    - Katzen
- *Outdoor Chalking Policy*: Outdoor chalking is permitted subject to the viewpoint-neutral time, place, and manner parameters outlined in this policy.
- *Tabling Policy:* This Policy outlines how RSOs, university departments/programs, and external organizations may receive permission to table for the purpose of distributing information, recruiting members, fundraising, and selling merchandise.
- *Posting Policy:* The purpose of this policy is to manage the posting of printed materials on campus in a way that ensures the appropriate use of available space and prevents littering and the defacing of university property.
- *Facilities Use Policy:* This Policy establishes guidelines for Acceptable Use and the management of both Indoor and Outdoor Spaces to ensure that all activities conducted within University Facilities support the institution's goals, the integrity of its spaces, and Users' ability to learn, live, work, study, engage, and express themselves freely. Important highlights from the policy include: The following activities are also not generally permitted; however, exceptions will be allowed when expressly authorized by the appropriate University official:
    - Selling or promoting commercial goods or services;
    - Using amplified sound in a manner inconsistent with the University's Amplified Sound Policy;
    - Blocking roadways, driveways, or creating any impediment to pedestrian or vehicular traffic;
    - Constructing structures, including objects requiring penetration in concrete or grass, on University grounds;
    - Alteration, attachment, affixing, or any other modification to University Facilities that may cause harm or damage;
    - Using fire or combustibles;
    - Demonstration activity as defined by this Policy that meets the standard for disturbing the peace under DC law because it has the effect of crowding, obstructing, or incommoding building entrances, sidewalks, or hallways within buildings; and
    - Occupying without authorization any portion of a building when it is normally closed or otherwise unavailable for public access. A building is "normally closed" when it is not open to the public due to its regular operating schedule or specific restrictions in place including closure due to emergencies, maintenance and repairs, and construction; and
    - Actively using skateboards, rollerblades, scooters, and bicycles inside University Facilities and on all indoor or outdoor steps or stairways. Any person operating a bicycle, scooter, skateboard, or rollerblade on campus property must do so without creating a hazard and must always yield to pedestrians. Bicycles must adhere to the same traffic laws as motor

vehicles, including stopping at stop signs, obeying traffic lights, yielding to pedestrians at crosswalks, and refraining from creating any hazards while riding

- *Event Scheduling & Management Policy:* Program facilities at American University are defined as either instructional spaces or event spaces and are available for scheduling by university departments or organizations according to the guidelines listed here. Important highlights from the policy include:
    - A. Restricted Use for Demonstrations
        - The University recognizes that free expression is important to its educational mission and to the civic life of the campus and community. Additional limitations on space use are designed to ensure physical safety of people and sensitive equipment, maintain and protect critical University operations and functions, and support privacy and confidentiality of documents and data as required by law. Demonstrations as defined in the Facilities Use Policy are prohibited in these spaces as follows:
        - Inside residence halls, research laboratories, computer labs, the Terrace Dining Room (TDR), Kay Spiritual Life Center (KSLC) and private offices (excluding reception areas and lobbies). Scheduled vigils are permitted inside Kay Spiritual Life Center (KSLC).
        - Spaces within University Facilities containing valuable or sensitive materials, collections, equipment, or records (including educational, student-related, personnel, or financial records protected by law or University policy). These include, but are not limited to, libraries, the Office of Financial Aid, The Health Center, The Office of the University Registrar, and The Wellbeing Center.
        - Scheduled Classrooms, seminar rooms, auditoriums, and meeting rooms where classes or private meetings are currently in session or imminently scheduled to occur.
        - Critical Facilities such as emergency services, utility rooms, and other facilities essential to the University's operations.
- *Amplified Sound Policy:* This policy applies to all forms of sound increased by electronic means and produced in association with outdoor activities on property supervised by American University. Important highlights from the policy include: The use of amplified sound at outdoor activities must be approved in connection with a space reservation through University Event Scheduling. Approval is subject to the professional judgment of the University Center staff or designee as to the suitability of the proposed activity for the requested time and campus site. The use of amplified sound is prohibited on East Campus.
- *Social Media Policy:* Standards for managing the University's social media profiles and AU Community Members' personal use of social media.
- *Children on Campus and Working with Minors Policy:* In order to ensure that the essential functioning of the University is not impaired and that the safety of Minors is provided for, it is necessary to adhere to certain conditions governing the presence of Minors on the University's campus, as well as those participating in off- campus AU-sponsored programs. RSOs are required to contact their CSI advisor if they are interested in hosting potential activities with participation from minors.
- Other AU policies can be found at *https://www.american.edu/policies/*

Campus Resources

All AU students have access to a variety of resources to ensure their success and well-being. RSOs are encouraged to take advantage of these resources to assist in any organizational matters.

- **Care Network:** If you notice any members of your RSO experiencing a change in behavior or if you are concerned about a member's wellbeing, you can submit a Care Referral to the Office of the Dean of Students to get them the resources they need.
- **The Center for Well-Being Programs and Psychological Services:** The Well-Being Center has a range of resources for students and is also available to consult with faculty, should you have concerns about a student's well-being, including the university's Victim Support Advocate, who is available to meet with students who have been impacted by interpersonal violence or sexual assault.
- **Office of Equity and Title IX:** If you or another member of your organization experience or witness discrimination, harassment, or sexual misconduct, you can make a report to the Office of Equity and Title IX.
- **Center for Student Belonging:** CSB hosts inclusive programming and dialogue training, all of which can be used by RSOs.
- **Kay Spiritual Life Center:** Faith-based RSOs work closely with Kay on advising and programming. Any RSO is welcome to collaborate with the department, regardless of any relation or presence of faith in its mission.
- **Center for Leadership & Community Engagement**: CLCE offers programs and resources to RSOs to volunteer and service-learning opportunities in the Washington, D.C. community and beyond.
- **Mary Graydon Student Center**:. MGSC houses the Student Engagement Commons, which are student-specific programming and meeting spaces on the second floor. This is also a great space for RSO events and meetings since it is centrally located.
- **Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices:** OSARP manages all non-academic conduct matters involving students, recognized student organizations, organizations seeking recognition, and provisionally recognized student groups at American University, with the exception of students enrolled in the Washington College of Law. Any member of the university community may submit a report through the Student Conduct Complaint Form. OSARP also offers the opportunity to resolve certain RSO conduct matters through restorative conferences, where involved parties engage in facilitated conversations to acknowledge and repair harm.

RSO Communications

Engage

Engage is CSI's RSO management system. It allows members of the AU community to find student organizations and discover events happening on campus. Every RSO has a unique Engage page to manage their organization and advertise campus wide events. You can sign in using your AU log in information and manage your organization or explore what other RSOs are up to.

Flyer Printing

Flyers may not be posted without advance approval from the appropriate department or office, as applicable. All RSOs must have flyers match the Engage event page and approved by CSI; all fraternities and sororities must have flyers approved by FSL.

Minimum requirements for flyer printing:

- Title of the activity or service
- Name(s) of host organization(s)
- Date/time/confirmed location of activity
- Updated contact information
- The three openness and inclusion statements previously listed on page 41

To post flyers in MGSC, **a maximum of 5 copies** must be brought to the Mary Graydon Student Center office (MGSC 319) or emailed to mgcmarketing@american.edu before printing for approval. MGSC Staff will post flyers on designated bulletin boards in MGSC.

For academic buildings, the organization will have to hang the flyers themselves. Flyers can only be posted on general announcement bulletin boards and not department-specific boards.

Organizations interested in posting flyers in the Residence Halls, please visit: https://www.american.edu/student-affairs/housing/advertisements.cfm

Students are not allowed to leave flyers on tables or post them on walls, bus stops, or outside spaces due to property damage. You cannot post on trees, exteriors of buildings, painted, wall-papered, or glass surfaces, building/classroom doors, car windshields, or bulletin boards administered by a university department without their permission. RSOs that post flyers in unapproved posting areas (elevators, walls, etc.) will be referred to the RSO Accountability and Resolution Procedure.

Websites

All recognized organizations have a page on Engage, AU's online platform for on-campus RSOs and events. Organizations are welcome to create their own website, but Engage is the primary platform for event advertising and communication. Posted external websites belonging to groups deriving their recognition from CSI must comply with all CSI and University policies. Students are also able to post the website link on their Engage page.

RSO Emails

Recognized student organizations are provided with an official AU organizational email account. This account is managed by the organization's Secretary who is responsible for regularly checking the email, and access is updated each year. CSI will send all announcements, deadlines, and policy updates to

this email. Your Engage profile should list your AU organizational email address as the Primary Contact. This email will serve as your organization's primary contact moving forward and should be used for:

- Communication with the Center for Student Involvement (CSI)
- Submitting forms and responding to official updates
- Contacting campus partners and external collaborators
- Maintaining continuity during officer transitions

Student officers should access the mailbox using Outlook Web Access (OWA) at office.com.

1. Open Outlook
2. Click your profile/name in the top right corner
3. Select "Open another mailbox"
4. Enter your organization's email address
5. Click Open
6. A new window will open displaying your organization's inbox.
7. If you are unable to access the account after following the steps above, please contact us at studentinvolvement@american.edu and we will assist you.

Social Media

CSI does not monitor or assume responsibility for student organization social media activity. RSO's social media must comply with the law, Student Conduct Code, and other university policies, including but not limited to the Discrimination and Non-Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy and the Title IX Sexual Harassment Policy. RSO social media content or conduct that violates this or other policies will be adjudicated in accordance with the established RSO conduct processes in section XVIII of the Student Conduct Code.

Guidance on the acceptable use of university-issued technology resources can be found in the Responsible Use of University Technology Resources Policy.

Fraternity & Sorority Life (FSL) Policies

Fraternity and Sorority Life recognition is the formal process by which American University permits a social fraternity or sorority to avail itself of certain university privileges. It applies to all social fraternities and sororities recognized under the Center for Student Involvement ("CSI") and Fraternity & Sorority Life ("FSL"). This policy applies to sorority and fraternity activities both on and off campus. This policy may be amended, rescinded, or superseded at any time by CSI or FSL.

CSI/FSL sets the University process for establishing or the presence of a fraternity or sorority on campus ("expansion" or " extension"), recruitment and intake policies. All organizations must abide by the University's recognition process.

Recognized Fraternities & Sororities are eligible for the following, specific benefits, opportunities, and resources subject to University policies, resource availability, and applicable recognition requirements:

1. Eligibility for participation in the student self-governing councils for recognized social sororities and fraternities;
2. Participation in the educational, philanthropic, service, social, and athletic programs and activities of the University that are provided for sororities and fraternities;
3. Eligibility to apply for a chapter room in residence halls, when available; and
4. Support for and participation in recruitment programs.

FSL Councils

American University ("University" or "AU") recognizes three governing councils and their respective member chapters within its fraternity and sorority community. These councils provide coordination and governance of their respective member chapters in accordance with University policies, council bylaws and constitutions, chapter governing documents, and applicable inter/national organization standards.

- **Interfraternity Council (IFC)**: governs all men's social fraternities that are, or have historically been members of the North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC), the national association representing men's fraternities and establishing standards for its member organizations.
    - **North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC)**- https://nicfraternity.org
- **Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC)**: governs the member chapters of recognized culturally based fraternal organizations affiliated with the National Pan-Hellenic Council (NPHC) or the National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations (NALFO).
    - **National Pan-Hellenic Council** – http://www.nnphchq.com/
    - **National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations** – https://nalfo.org
- **Panhellenic Council (PHC):** governs all women's social sororities recognized by the National Panhellenic Conference (NPC).
    - **National Panhellenic Conference** – https://npc.org/

Organizational Policy and Procedural Compliance and Stewardship

Recognition is required for an organization to be considered for University privileges, services, and resources. Organizations may obtain recognition by completing all expansion and recognized student organization processes and submitting required documentation, and by demonstrating a commitment to being a responsible steward of AU and FSL communities. Continued recognition of an organization is subject to ongoing compliance with the applicable expectations and requirements set forth in the RSO

Manual and FSL policies along with University policies and procedures.

Organizational Conduct Requirements

FSL organizations must comply with applicable federal, state, and local, laws and regulations, the policies and procedure of their inter/national headquarters, and applicable University and FSL policies and procedures. Alleged conduct violations of University or FSL policies may be referred to the Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices (OSARP), Equity and Title IX office, and/or FSL judicial processes, consistent with applicable University administrative policies and processes.

FSL organizations may not independently manage, investigate, adjudicate, or otherwise address potential violations of University conduct policies, including the Student Conduct and nondiscrimination policies. Students are encouraged to report these concerns to the appropriate University offices when such concerns arise.

Insurance Coverage Requirements

As a condition of University recognition, each fraternity and sorority member chapter must be recognized by an inter/national headquarters and maintain Commercial General Liability insurance with limits of not less than $1,000,000 per occurrence, or such other limits as may be established by the University. The required coverage may be maintained by the chapter or through its inter/national organization, provided that the policy extends coverage to the chapter and its operations and activities. Chapters must provide AU with a current certificate of insurance and naming American University as an additional insured upon initial recognition and annually thereafter.

Categories of Recognition

A fraternity or sorority is designated in one of the following stages of recognition:

1. **Provisionally Recognized Student Organization**: a student led group that has received provisional status through a recognition process from the Center for Student Involvement and an inter/national organization that has been approved to pursue recognition under one of the Fraternity and Sorority Life councils. Provisionally recognized organizations are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. The University may address incidents of misconduct involving groups who have received provisional recognition through organizational and/or individual conduct charges.
    a. All organizations interested in joining the Fraternity & Sorority community must follow FSL expansion/extension guidelines
    b. All organizations interested in joining the Fraternity & Sorority community must follow the respective Council expansion/extension policy in which they seek recognition (if applicable)
    c. Once approved, new recognized student organizations will have the benefits and responsibilities tied to recognition, including the public use of American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets. Until such time that provisionally recognized student organization is approved, they may not publicly use American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets, including on social media, except for the explicit purposes of recruitment and activities tied to the provisionally recognized process as defined by the Center for Student Involvement or recognizing department.
    d. Provisionally recognized student organizations that receive initial approval to go through the

registration process will be considered for 'Recognized' status for the following academic semester upon completion of all required recognition components.

e. Provisionally recognized student organizations are held to the same conduct expectations as organizations seeking recognition.

2. **Recognized Student Organization**: a student led and created group that has been formally recognized by the Center for Student Involvement or another university department and has benefits and responsibilities tied to recognition. The University may address incidents of misconduct involving groups who have received recognition through organizational and/or individual conduct charges.
    a. Any RSO that completes the proper procedures for registration and meets set requirements is eligible to receive the privileges and responsibilities associated with being a recognized student organization. Recognition must be received from the proper council or board, as delineated by CSI.
3. **Probation:** describes an organization who is considered not in good standing with FSL, CSI, AU, or a combination therein.
    a. Organizations may be placed on this status, or any other interim action, by the Dean of Students, CSI, FSL, or their designee, pending an investigation(s), hearing(s), or meeting(s) related to a violation of policies and procedures;
    b. Organizations may also be placed on this status if their Inter/National Headquarters has placed any sanctions or additional status onto the chapter;
    c. This status may include sanctions including, but not limited to:
        i. social probation, academic probation, additional meetings with university officials, censure, educational sanctions, educational programs, revision of programs, risk management revisions, alcohol education workshops, leadership development programming, and leadership development participation.
    d. Organizations on Probation:
        i. Will be required to follow FSL, SCCRS, and/or Inter/National Organization sanctions;
        ii. Are considered “not in good standing”;
        iii. Must complete the requirements set forth to be removed from probation.
    e. Organizations on Probation for three semesters or have a history of conduct violations will have their status reviewed by FSL to determine viability and/or sustainability on campus.
        i. Status review may include, but not limited to:
            1. Consultation with the Executive Director of Student Engagement and Student Center;
            2. Discussion with chapter leadership;
            3. Discussion with Inter/National Headquarters staff.
        ii. The outcome(s) of this discussion may result in further sanctions or being placed on an Unrecognized status.
4. **Unrecognized Student Organization:** Unrecognized student organizations include groups that have never been formally recognized through the Center for Student Involvement or any other university department, groups that were once previously organizations seeking recognition, and previously recognized organizations that have been denied recognition, or have lost their recognition, due to administrative reasons. Unrecognized student organizations are not entitled to the privileges and

benefits of recognized student organizations. Behavioral incidents involving an unrecognized group will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Unrecognized student organizations are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets. Any fraternity or sorority that is currently unrecognized by the university must follow the FSL expansion/extension guidelines and procedures.

a. Failure to follow the required procedures for expansion and recognition may result in the organization to be deprived of recognition.
b. Organizations will be placed on this status if they have been placed on inactive status by the Center for Student Involvement and Fraternity & Sorority Life for a period of at least 2 years.
c. Organizations may be placed on this status for a pattern or incident of misconduct, criminal activity, fiscal default, or neglect that poses an unacceptable risk of harm to persons or property, including liability or financial loss to the University or FSL community.
d. Circumstances and conduct which are cause for this status include, but are not limited to:
    i. Student Conduct Code violations including, but not limited to hazing, alcohol and other drugs, public/private/University property damage, etc.;
    ii. Recurring social or academic probation or a violation of probation;
    iii. Failure to pay University fees, charges, or other obligations to the institution;
    iv. Failure to exercise appropriate care in using and maintaining University facilities and spaces;
    v. Suspension, charter revocation, withdrawal of inter/national affiliation, or other disciplinary action by its inter/national organization.
    vi. Failure to comply with any of the Center for Student Involvement's Recognition/FSL Recognition Standards.
    vii. Organizations on this status will be ineligible for the benefits outlined in this policy.

5. **Separated Organization:** a formerly recognized student organization or group that has lost University recognition on a permanent basis as a consequence of violations of the Code and/or other policies. Separation is permanent removal (i.e. expulsion) from the university community and permanent loss of all privileges of recognition. Behavioral incidents involving organizations will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Separated Organizations are not affiliated with American University and are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets.
6. **Underground Group:** a formerly recognized student organization or group that has lost university recognition on a permanent basis as a consequence of violations of the Code and/or other policies and continues to operate and function despite the directive not to do so. Underground groups are not entitled to the privileges and benefits of recognized student organizations. Behavior incidents involving an underground group will result in individual conduct charges for those involved. Underground groups are prohibited from using American University's name, logos, marks or other official/registered assets.
7. **Inactive:** describes a chapter in good standing with no AU membership organization who has experienced inactivity not due to Conduct-related reasons.
    a. Inactive Status may include one or more of the following reasons:
        i. The Inter/National Headquarters has suspended activity for reasons not related to conduct.

ii. The active members have changed their membership status with their respective Inter/National Headquarters and as a result, the organization is no longer able to operate.
iii. The organization has no active undergraduate members remaining.

b. Organizations who do not have any members for three (3) consecutive Fall/Spring semesters will be placed on Inactive status.
c. CSI/FSL will work with the organization's Inter/National Headquarters to have their own staff and/or local alumni/ae attempt to garner interest from AU students.
d. Chapters that are on Inactive Status must complete the following requirements to resume operations:
    i. Complete FSL Return to Campus Plan which includes the following:
        1. A detailed document that outlines their plan for increased engagement in the AU community, covering at minimum 2 semesters
        2. Submit a detailed plan for all proposed recruitment practices and events
        3. Submit a plan from the chapter's graduate/alumni team detailing how they will support the chapter's recruitment efforts and overall health.
        4. Letter of support from the chapter's headquarters indicating they are in good standing and able to recruit
        5. Schedule a meeting with the graduate/alumni team and FSL staff to go over AU policy and guidelines.
        6. Attend monthly meetings with the FSL Team.
        7. All plans must be reviewed and approved by the CSI/FSL.
e. When a chapter has been placed on an Inactive Status and has not completed the above requirements, they are no longer considered a Recognized Student Organization.
    i. Includes loss of ability to begin or participate in any recruitment practices (for city wide chapters this includes recruitment practices on any affiliated campus)
    ii. Once a chapter has completed the above requirements and received approval they will move to a Provisional Status.
f. If a chapter fails to recruit and retain any AU students after two years on a Provisional Status the chapter will be placed on an Unrecognized status. (Refer to Section 6, Subsection 4 for more details.). There will be no exceptions or extensions to this policy.

Recognition Process-Expansion Policy

The mission of Fraternity and Sorority Life (FSL)/Center for Student Involvement is to enhance the quality of student life at American University by empowering members of the community through advising with a developmental approach, educating with a purpose, collaborating with stakeholders, promoting academic success, empowering civic engagement, and social justice, advocating for healthy lifestyles, creating lifelong connections, and advancing values-based leadership.

The purpose of the expansion policy for Fraternity and Sorority Life/Center for Student Involvement at American University is to support the advancement of all fraternities and sororities, provide new opportunities for non-affiliated students, and foster an inclusive, engaged, and vibrant community.

<u>Eligibility Criteria for Interested Groups:</u>

Fraternities and sororities wishing to become a registered social organization at American University must meet the following criteria.

1. Affiliation with an inter/national sorority or fraternity.
2. Affiliation with a governing council recognized through the Center for Student Involvement.
3. Limit membership to currently enrolled, undergraduate degree-seeking students at American University that meet the Center for Student Involvement's eligibility requirements.
4. Demonstrate General Liability insurance with a minimum of $1,000,000 per occurrence. The interested group will provide American University with a current certificate of insurance evidencing the coverage required and naming American University as an additional insured on the policy. Certificates are to be sent each year as the policy renews.
5. Ongoing compliance with the Student Code of Conduct and good standing with the university and the inter/national organization.
6. A commitment to all the minimum requirements and standards set by the Center for Student Involvement.
7. Refraining from membership marketing, recruitment, intake, interest meetings, etc. until the completion of the Fraternity and Sorority Expansion Process.
8. A process that allows a chapter to go from a provisional chapter to a fully chartered chapter that is completed within four (4) semesters.

American University's Fraternity and Sorority Membership Requirements

1. American University Fraternity & Sorority Life has established a delayed membership process to better meet the needs of the AU community and FSL members. For students to be eligible, they must meet the following requirements:
    a. Be enrolled as a full-time matriculated undergraduate student;
    b. Be in Good Disciplinary Standing with AU;
    c. Have earned a minimum of 12 credit hours at AU, after high school graduation;
        i. Transfer students with 12 credit hours from an accredited college or university are eligible;
        ii. Advanced Placement (AP), International Baccalaureate (IB), or Dual-Enrollment credits do not qualify as acceptable credits;
    d. Have earned a minimum grade point average GPA of 2.5 on a 4.0 scale.

Expressing Interest

Inter/National organization representatives or students interested in bringing a fraternity or sorority to campus may fill out a formal interest form provided on the Fraternity and Sorority Life website.

1. The interest form may be submitted at any time, regardless of an active expansion process.
2. During an active expansion process, submission of an interest form is not required.
3. Interest forms will be reviewed twice a year on July 15th and February 15th.

Interest Form Requirements

Organizations that are interested in joining the American University Fraternity and Sorority Community must provide the following information via Engage form:

1. Explanation of interest in American University.

2. Indication of which council the organization would affiliate with.
    a. Interfraternity Council
    b. Intercultural Greek Collective
    c. Panhellenic council
3. Contact information for a representative that has oversight of expansion from the national organization.
4. Organizations must complete the Expansion Application upon being notified of review by Fraternity/Sorority Life.

Link to Expansion Interest: Expansion Interest Form

Expansion Review

Organizations who are interested in opening/re-establishing/re-activating at American University, must submit a form with the required information.

1. The Center for Student Involvement will review all documents following the Interest Form review period mentioned above.
2. The organization will be asked to provide additional documentation in the form of an Expansion Application via Engage to support the request for a new organization joining the Fraternity/Sorority community.
3. Once the information has been reviewed, the Center for Student Involvement will make a final decision and notify the organization of their preliminary status.
4. Following this notification, FSL will coordinate a Meet and Greet and Information Session with the interest's respective council. A vote from the community is to follow.
5. If an organization is accepted, the organization will follow the processes of their respective councils/collective.

Annual Review for Expansion

Independently, the Center for Student Involvement will annually assess community statistics (I.e. recruitment statistics, expansion interest etc.) to determine if the fraternity/sorority community should open for expansion. If there are no interested organizations, the Center for Student Involvement may make the recommendation to seek out groups who may be interested in joining American University's Fraternity/Sorority community.

1. If the Center for Student Involvement determines the community should open for expansion, the recommended Council/Collective will follow its bylaws and/or the process outlined by the national governing body to determine if that Council will open for expansion.
    a. American University will work with the outlined process provided by a national governing body; however, all American University requirements must be met.

Application Form Requirements

1. Declaration of Intent: Submit a letter from Inter/national President, Executive Director, or student interest group expressing a desire to form an undergraduate chapter.
2. Organization Contact Information – Provide the following:
    a. Inter/national Fraternity or Sorority mailing address;

    b. Headquarters contact information (including, name, phone number, and email)
3. Outline the requirements that must be met before the newly formed organization will be chartered.
4. Provide copies of the following organization policies, procedures, and programs:
    a. Academic Policy
    b. Financial Policies (Dues, new member fees, initiation fees, etc.)
    c. Standards/Conduct Policies and Procedures
    d. New Member Education Program
    e. Recruitment/Intake Process
    f. National Member Statistics
    g. Risk Management Policy and Procedures
    h. Leadership and Personal Development Programs
    i. Proof of Insurance
    j. Documentation of a 501(c)(7) tax status by the Internal Revenue Service.
    k. List of previous expansion efforts in the past five (5) years.
    l. Resources provided by the national organization, including:
        i. List of chapters in surrounding areas.
        ii. Structure of volunteer support.
        iii. The names of chapter advisors, if available.
        iv. Description of advisory board, including set-up, expectations, training, and roles).

Overview of Expansion Procedure

Approved groups are expected to follow one of the three specific procedures: Interfraternity Expansion Procedure, Intercultural Greek Collective Expansion Procedure, or Panhellenic Organization Extension Procedure. These procedures are designed specifically to fit the needs of the organizations and umbrella group that are interested in joining American University's Fraternity/Sorority Community.

Interfraternity Expansion Procedure

Groups interested in joining the Interfraternity Council must follow one of the processes outlined below:

1. Open Invitation to Establish New Organization: In the event the IFC wishes to seek expansion opportunities, a formal invitation shall be sent to inter/national organizations requesting Letters of Intent.
    a. If multiple inter/national organizations submit Expansion Interest Form, the IFC Council will coordinate with the (inter)national organizations to establish an agreeable timeline for expansion.
        i. Information will be solicited from all (inter)national organizations. Based on the information provided, the IFC will vote to invite no more than 3 organizations to present to the IFC.
        ii. IFC will decide on which group would be fit for American University's fraternity community.
        iii. IFC will vote on whether expansion should move forward with the recommended group.
2. Inter/national Fraternity Establishment: The (inter)national fraternity must fill out an interest form

on the Center for Student Involvement's website to determine eligibility. This Expansion Interest Form shall be shared with the IFC Council.
    a. IFC will vote on whether expansion should move forward with this group.
3. Independent Student Interest
    a. If a student expresses interest in starting a new (inter)national fraternity on American University's campus, they should schedule a meeting with Fraternity and Sorority Life/Center for Student Involvement.
    b. After CSI/FSL conducts a review and acquires initial information, IFC will vote on whether expansion should move forward with this group.

Intercultural Greek Collective Expansion Procedure

Groups interested in joining the Intercultural Greek Collective must follow one of the processes outlined below:

1. Inter/national Fraternity Establishment: The (inter)national fraternity must fill out an interest form on the Center for Student Involvement's website to determine eligibility. This Expansion Interest Form shall be shared with the IGC Council.
    a. IGC will vote on whether expansion should move forward with this group.
2. Independent Student Interest:
    a. If a student expresses interest in starting a group that would affiliate with the Intercultural Greek Collective on American University's campus, they should schedule a meeting with Fraternity and Sorority Life/Center for Student Involvement.
    b. After CSI/FSL conducts a review and acquires initial information, IGC will vote on whether expansion should move forward with this group.
3. Citywide organization models will no longer be accepted at American University.

Panhellenic Council Expansion Procedure

Interest groups who have submitted information regarding expansion/extension to form an organization under the umbrella group of the National Panhellenic Conference (NPC) must understand that the Panhellenic Extension Procedures strictly follow the NPC Manual of Information (MOI).
The College Panhellenic council should consult with the NPC Area Advisor, the NPC Extension Committee Chairman, and the Center for Student Involvement if they believe that they are at a point of extension without a formal interest group in existence. In the case when neither an interest group nor application for expansion has been submitted, the College Panhellenic can form an extension committee to research and recommend whether Panhellenic extension should or should not be considered. If the College Panhellenic finds in favor of extension without an approved interest group, they must consult with the Center for Student Involvement who will consider if the campus can support moving forward without an approved interest group.

In the case of no approved interest group, the following steps should be taken:

1. The College Panhellenic votes to open the campus for extension.
2. If the College Panhellenic votes to open, an Extension Committee is appointed by the NPC Area Advisor, and the NPC Extension Committee chairman is contacted with the decision.
3. College Panhellenic asks the Chairman of the Extension Committee to notify all NPC organizations of the extension opportunity and/or send a letter of introduction to specific NPC organizations to

solicit interest in extension.

4. College Panhellenic looks over submissions and ultimately selects several organizations to make presentations. Arrangements are made by the Center for Student Involvement and College Panhellenic Council for a campus presentation. Those groups not selected are notified by the Extension Committee and/or Center for Student Involvement
5. After presentations, College Panhellenic decides which group meets the needs of the campus and works with the Center for Student Involvement to issue an invitation. All information for selection, vote, and issue of offer is located in the NPC MOI. College Panhellenic notifies the other groups of the selection.

Re-establishment Agreements

The Center for Student Involvement reserves the right to make all decisions regarding re-establishment agreements on a case-by-case basis.

Requirements for Annual and Ongoing Organization Recognition

1. Recognition is subject to annual renewal. To complete the annual recognition process, organizations are expected to:
    a. Complete the CSI student organization annual renewal process annual recognition process by:
        i. Participation in required trainings Beginning in Spring 2026 for the 2026-2027 academic year, annual renewal training requirements will be incorporated into the ongoing training expectations for RSOs throughout the academic year. Failure to complete required trainings may result in the RSO being placed in a frozen status or losing access to organizational privileges or benefits, such as the ability to reserve space on campus or utilize funding.
    b. Submit Annual Report
    c. Representation at FSL Leadership Retreat
    d. Provide a letter of chapter standing from the organization's inter/national Headquarters;
    e. Provide a current Certificate of Insurance (COI) demonstrating insurance policy coverage with limits of at least $1,000,000 (one million) for each individual occurrence;
    f. Maintain good standing in one of three Governing Councils: Interfraternity Council (IFC), Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC), or Panhellenic Council (PHC), including but not limited to:
        i. Pay council dues
        ii. Have representation at all respective council meetings
        iii. Have representation at all monthly FSL Leadership meetings
    g. Comply with the Recognized Student Organization manual, Center for Student Involvement, Fraternity & Sorority Life and University policies, including, but not limited to:
        i. AU Alcohol and Other Drug Policies;
        ii. AU Hazing Policy;
        iii. AU Student Conduct Code;
        iv. AU Good Neighbor Guidelines;
        v. CSI Policies;

vi. Housing & Residence Life Rules and Regulations;
vii. FSL Recruitment, Intake, and New Member Education Standards and Procedures.

h. Submit a copy of the organization's charter establishing the organization's affiliation with AU, unless such documentations is on file with FSL. For city-wide chapters, see Section 7.

2. As part of ongoing recognition, organizations are expected to maintain current organizational information for inclusion on the appropriate FSL webpage(s) of the University website and publications, as appropriate, and provide applicable updates or submissions during the semester as requested by FSL. These expectations include, but are not limited to: :
   i. An updated Engage platform;
      i. Current Constitution and/or Bylaws;
      ii. Leadership Roster;
      iii. Chapter/Graduate Advisor, name and contact info;
      iv. Organization Point of Contact Information;
      v. Description of Organization;
      vi. Profile Picture;
   j. Submission of the following information:
      i. Membership Roster;
      ii. Leadership Roster and Contact Info;
      iii. Primary Chapter Advisor and Contact Information;
      iv. Program and Activity schedules for:
         1. Recruitment;
         2. Information Sessions;
         3. Intake;
         4. New Member Education;
      v. Meeting(s) with respective FSL Advisor;
      vi. Community Service Hours;
      vii. Philanthropic Funds Raised.

Leadership and Advisor Roles

1. The Chapter President, or designee, will be the primary point of contact for the organization with the University regarding the following:
   a. Ensuring that all requested and/or required materials are submitted on time (i.e. rosters, new member education, etc.); and
   b. Serving as the primary contact for behavioral/conduct information or allegation reported to the Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices, when applicable.
2. The Chapter/Graduate Advisor is an alumni/alumnae member who supports the organization at the local level within the Washington, DC area. The Chapter/Graduate Advisor will:
   a. Reside in the local Washington, DC, Maryland, Virginia area and be reasonably accessible to the organization;
   b. Be the primary advisor contact for the organization;
   c. Serve as a liaison between the organization and its inter/national headquarters; and
   d. Be formally recognized as an advisor through the organization's inter/national Headquarters.

City-Wide Chapter/Organizations

A fraternal organization whose membership consisting of students from American University and other collegiate institutions is considered a city-wide chapter/organization.

1. New organizations seeking University recognition are not eligible to establish or obtain city-wide status.
    a. Organizations on campus currently recognized by the University with city-wide status may retain that status subject to continued compliance with applicable University and FSL policies and requirements.
    b. If an organization's charter is revoked or otherwise removed, or if the organization loses University recognition, it will not retain status as a city-wide chapter if it subsequently seeks recognition or returns to campus.
2. In addition to complying with all applicable University, FSL, and inter/national organization policies, processes, and requirements, a recognized city-wide chapter/organization must meet the following requirements to maintain city-wide status:
    a. Submitted a copy of the organization's charter, if not already on file with FSL;
    b. Have and maintain sponsorship from the inter/national headquarters office; and
    c. Have the majority of its membership must be located at the institution where the chapter is chartered.

If the organization does not have at least one (1) student from AU for three (3) consecutive semesters, the organization will be placed on an Inactive status, in accordance with Section 7 Subsection *Categories of Identification o*f this policy. Placement on inactive status may affect the organization's eligibility to maintain recognition status as a city-wide chapter/organization at AU.

3. Participants who are not enrolled at AU, will be considered guests of the organization.
    a. Organizations are held responsible for the conduct of their guests and may be held accountable for violations of University policies resulting from guest conduct.
4. In the event the Chapter President is not an AU student, the organization must designate an official liaison who is an active, enrolled AU student to serve as the organization's primary point of contact with the University/FSL.
    a. In the event the organization does not have any members enrolled at AU, the organization must designate an official liaison from their Executive Board to the University/FSL.
        i. Organizations are required to coordinate all room reservations through FSL. Please note that space is limited, and requests may not always be granted in full
5. If a citywide organization does not have at least one (1) student from AU for three (3) consecutive semesters, the organization will be placed on an Inactive Status for a period of 2 years. An organization seeking city-wide status following placement on Inactive status must satisfy all recognition requirements set forth in the definition of Inactive status in this policy. Those requirements, as incorporated by reference, include completion and approval of the applicable Return to Campus Plan.

Inactive, Separated and Unrecognized Organization Statuses

If an FSL organization becomes inactive, is no longer recognized, or separates from the University, and there are not active efforts or plans for the organization to return within two (2) years of their change

in recognition status, the Center for Student Involvement, with approval from the Assistant Vice President for Student Engagement, may reallocate any remaining funds raised by the organization to student organizations with missions that closely align with that of the original organization.

Recruitment, Intake, and New Member Education Standards

Introduction

As detailed above, the Center for Student Involvement (CSI) is a host to inter/national fraternities and sororities at American University (AU) that belong to one of the following governing councils: Interfraternity Council (IFC), Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC), or the Panhellenic Council (PHC). Fraternity and sorority chapters are recognized by their inter/national headquarters and are advised at AU by Fraternity & Sorority Life (FSL) staff within the Center for Student Involvement (CSI). The Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices and/or FSL may place sanctions on organizations in relation to recruitment or information sessions.

American University practices delayed recruitment which means first year students are not eligible to join a social fraternity or sorority until their second semester. Delayed Recruitment allows for first-year students to engage with their academics, acclimate to the University, learn more about the FSL community, and develop friendships with other AU students prior to joining a social Greek-lettered organization. The delayed recruitment process also allows prospective members to make a more informed decision about whether fraternity or sorority life is the best choice for their college experience.

All organizations and students must adhere to University, FSL, Council, and Inter/National Organization related policies and procedures, including but not limited to: Code of Student Conduct, Council Constitutions and Bylaws, Council-specific policies and procedures, FSL recognition policy, and Recruitment, Intake, and New Member Education policies. If organizations or students violate any of these policies and procedures, they are subject to referral to the Office of Student Accountability & Restorative Practices and/or FSL for any judicial action or sanctions.

Definitions

1. Aspirant is a commonly used term by culturally based fraternal organizations to describe a potential member.
2. Informational/Rush is a commonly used term by culturally based fraternal organizations to describe an event for potential members to learn more about the organization, just before they seek membership into the organization.
3. Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC) is a governing council on AU's campus that is comprised of culturally based social fraternities and sororities affiliated with the National Pan-Hellenic Council (NPHC), National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations (NALFO), and National APIDA Panhellenic Association (NAPA).
4. Interfraternity Council (IFC) is a governing council on AU's campus that is comprised of social fraternities affiliated with the North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC).
5. National Multicultural Greek Council (NMGC) is the national umbrella organization for a coalition of multicultural Greek-lettered social organizations (MGLOs). There are a total of 10 member organizations, of which there are no organizations represented at AU.
6. National Association of Latino Fraternal Organizations (NALFO) is the national umbrella organization

for Latinx social fraternities and sororities. There are 24 member organizations; currently, there is one (1) organization represented on AU's campus and is a member of the Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC).

7. National Pan-Hellenic Council (NPHC) is the international umbrella organization for nine historically African American/Black fraternities and sororities, also known as the "Divine Nine." Currently, five (5)) NPHC organizations are represented on AU's campus and are members of the Intercultural Greek Collective (IGC).
8. National Panhellenic Conference (NPC) is the national umbrella organization for 26 inter/national women's fraternities and sororities, seven (7) of which have chapters on AU's campus and are members of the Panhellenic Council (PHC).
9. North American Interfraternity Conference (NIC) is the national umbrella organization of men's fraternities, which includes 66 inter/national fraternal organizations. Currently, there are ten (10) of these organizations on AU's campus and are members of the Interfraternity Council (IFC).
10. New Member is defined as a student who has accepted a membership invitation, is not a current active member, and/or actively going through an educational process for the organization.
11. New Member Presentation/Showcase/Reveal is a commonly used term by culturally based fraternal organizations to describe an event where new members are to "reveal" themselves to the public. This event includes, but not limited to, the new members presenting the organization's founders, history, values, and chapter related information.
12. Panhellenic Council (PHC) is a governing council on AU's campus that is comprised of social sororities affiliated with the National Panhellenic Conference (NPC).
13. Potential New Member (PNM) is defined as an interested student going through a social fraternity/sorority recruitment process and is not currently a member of a recognized FSL organization
14. Recruitment is defined as a program (and period of time) of membership selection by fraternal organizations, most notably used within Interfraternity Council (IFC) and Panhellenic Council (PHC).
15. Primary Recruitment is defined as a major recruitment period during the year with specific schedule of events, concluding with a day designated for the handing out of membership bids, known as "Bid Day."
16. Informal Recruitment is defined as a minor recruitment period during the year in which the schedule of events is less structured. The different Council's may have additional policies or procedures specific to governing their member organizations.
17. "Continuous Open Bidding" (COB) is a term used by Panhellenic Council (PHC) to describe informal recruitment.
18. Rush – see "Recruitment" definition.

Delayed Membership Requirements

American University Fraternity & Sorority Life (AU FSL) established a delayed membership process to better meet the needs of the AU community and FSL members. For students to be eligible, they must meet the following requirements:

1. Be enrolled as a full-time matriculated undergraduate student;
2. Be in Good Disciplinary Standing with AU;
3. Earned a minimum of 12 credit hours at AU, after high school graduation;

a. Transfer students with 12 credit hours from an accredited college or university are eligible;
b. Advanced Placement (AP), International Baccalaureate (IB), or Dual-Enrollment credits do not qualify as acceptable credits;

4. Have earned a minimum cumulative grade point average (GPA) of 2.5 on a 4.0 scale.

Note: Some organizations may have additional or more stringent requirements specific to their membership qualifications.

Requirements for Organizations

1. Organizations must meet with their respective FSL Advisor to review the organization's recruitment schedule, informational schedule, and new member education schedule five (5) business days in advance of the first meeting. Each schedule must be submitted in advance of the meeting to provide ample time for the FSL Advisor to review. The schedule(s) of events must include, but not limited to:
    a. Informational Meetings;
    b. Selection Date(s);
    c. Dates, times, and locations of all Recruitment, Informational, and New Member programs, events, activities, etc.
    d. Initiation/Crossing Date;
    e. Presentation of New Members (if applicable);
    f. Any additional dates or information required by FSL or the inter/national organization.
2. In the event any information need to be changed on the calendars of events, chapter members and officers are expected to notify FSL in writing no less than five (5) business days prior to the new event time or calendar due dates set by the governing council.
3. All recruitment, informational, and new member activities and events must adhere to the following requirements:
    a. No alcoholic beverages will be permitted;
    b. All inter/national organization policies of the organization as well as the governing council must be met;
    c. All activities are subject to the Code of Student Conduct;
    d. Any event that would be perceived by a reasonable observer as an organizational activity is subject to these rules;
    e. No events or activities can take place during any university breaks or holidays (fall, winter, and spring breaks, summer, MLK Jr. Holiday, etc.);
    f. No events or activities are to occur until the beginning of the Primary or Informal Recruitment Week, each semester;
    g. No events or activities are to occur during the All-American Welcome weeks, prior to any formal/informal recruitment events or activities;
4. No invitations for membership can be given to students who have not been verified by FSL.
    a. If a student is not verified by FSL, the invitation for membership will be retracted immediately and the member organization issuing the membership invitation may be subject to the suspension of all recruitment, informational, or new member activities and any further judicial action. This process of giving unofficial invitations for membership to those who are ineligible is commonly defined as "ghost pledging" and is subject to this

policy.

5. To confirm eligibility of students, all organizations must provide FSL staff with contact info for every prospective member prior to issuing a membership invitation, including, but not limited to:
    a. Legal First and Last Name
    b. AU Identification Number
    c. AU Email Address
    d. Primary Phone Number
    e. If a Council has a Formal Recruitment Process, the deadline for registration must close before or soon after the start of recruitment.
6. All recruitment, informational, and new member events or activities must be in on-campus facilities, unless otherwise approved by an FSL staff member.
7. All organizations must have their initiation and new member presentation (if applicable) occur no later than two Sundays before final exams each semester.
8. If a new member drops or discontinues the education or intake process, prior to initiation or new member presentation, chapters must notify FSL within 48 hours.
9. At the conclusion of the organization's new member program, the organization must submit an updated roster, confirming the initiated or crossed members.
10. After membership is extended to eligible students, organizations are required to have new members sign the Anti-Hazing and Grade Release Form within 48 hours after accepting a membership invitation.
11. IGC Organizations: Must complete and adhere to the required Recruitment/Intake paperwork prior to any activity or event. Recruitment/Intake paperwork is found on Engage.

Fraternity & Sorority Life Advisors

1. Fraternity & Sorority Life (FSL) staff members are the Primary Advisors for the three (3) FSL Councils and their respective organizations on AU's campus.
2. FSL Advisors are the University Officials who sign all recruitment/intake paperwork required by the inter/national organization.

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AMERICAN UNIVERSITY

Finance Manual

Important Policies & Procedures

Student Activity Fee

Recognized student organizations receive funding from the undergraduate or graduate Student Activity Fee (SAF), which all matriculating full-time ($175 per semester for undergraduates; $50 per semester for graduate students) and part-time ($30 per semester; $50 per semester for graduate students) students at American University pay through their tuition. The **undergraduate** fee is allocated through the Budget Advisory Committee process, which is made up of representatives from the governance boards. The **graduate** fee is allocated toward all recognized graduate-level groups under the Graduate Leadership Council and the Graduate Student Councils.

Student activity fee funds can be requested by recognized student organizations to host events or provide an activity accessible to **all** AU students. They cannot be requested when organizations are deriving any revenue from the funds, such as through winning money at competitions or by charging students or schools to attend or participate in the event. Student activity funds also cannot be used when only a few select students are benefiting from the funds. Travel, where a few members represent the organization, is acceptable on a case-by-case basis (i.e., a conference).

All purchases using Student Activity Fee money must abide by CSI finance procedures and the University Mandatory Fee guidelines.

To use SAF money, all funded organizations must submit a Purchase Request (AUCC & GLC RSOs require a Budget Request before submitting a Purchase Request) to the CSI Finance team on Engage.

Net30 Payment Policy

American University has a Net30 Policy, and CSI ***does not pay any deposits or pre-pay for any space, service, or product***. Vendors must agree to the Net30 policy for us to use their services. It is the organization's responsibility to confirm with the vendor/venue that they will accept this policy. For example, bowling alleys require a deposit or prepayment, making it an ineligible activity.

Payments are processed in the order in which they are received by Accounts Receivable. Payments cannot be guaranteed on a certain day or time.

Credit Card Authorization Requests: Some vendors may request a credit card authorization as a guarantee in lieu of a deposit or prepayment. CSI will complete and submit the authorization form **only after** the contract has been reviewed and approved by both parties.

Forms of Payment

CSI pays vendors either by check (regardless of the amount) or by credit card if the amount is less than $10,000.00. CSI does not use cash apps.

CSI processes payments by credit card either over the phone during business hours, through a verified payment link, or by submitting a credit card authorization form. Please note that evening, weekend, or in-person payments are not available as options.

Retrieving Orders

When placing orders, there are three different methods for receiving your items:

- Pick-Up: Students will retrieve the items themselves from local stores or restaurants. (Examples:

Food orders from restaurants, Target, Giant, Michaels, Walmart, etc.)

- Shipping: This refers to the delivery of packages from one location to another. Packages are delivered to the AU Mail room and then forwarded to our office. (Examples: Amazon, Walmart, Target, Michaels, etc.)
- Delivery: This involves getting the package directly into the hands of the recipient. Delivery is conducted by either the store itself or a delivery service company. (Examples: Food orders from restaurants, Target, Walmart, etc.)

Please note: Deliveries can only be made to locations on campus and directly to students, not to the CSI office.

CSI processes deliveries and assigns lockers for RSO packages.

- The Treasurer or President (whoever submitted the PR) will receive a QTrack email with a QR code and passcode to retrieve the package from the locker.
- Lockers are located on the third floor of the MGSC.
- Packages must be picked up within 48 hours. A reminder email will be sent before the deadline.
- After 48 hours, packages will be removed, and CSI is not responsible for lost items or reordering. Failure to consistently pick up packages will result in a loss of funding.

Travel Policy

The following rules and regulations govern planning for official, college-sanctioned travel of recognized student organizations at American University. College-sanctioned travel by recognized student organizations includes travel funded by university funds or travel to competitions or conferences where individual members are representing their organization and/or American University. All travel must be registered with CSI, even if university funds are not being utilized. International travel by recognized student organizations is prohibited; exceptions may be made by the Executive Director; in such cases, the organization's faculty/staff advisors or other supervisory personnel from the university must attend. Travel within the DMV is considered a simple event, while travel outside of the local/DMV area is considered complex, so appropriate timelines must be followed.

Note: This travel policy does not cover participation in Faith-based Service trips or Service Trips as defined by the Center for Leadership and Community Engagement. Service trips are defined as multiple-day trips to perform community service activities and/or engage with a Community-Based organization, nonprofit, or school centered on learning about a social issue. That said, RSOs may still apply for funding for multi-day service trips; however, they must also work with CLCE or the sponsoring office to ensure all proper protocols are followed in trip planning and execution.

To fulfill a travel request, you must meet the minimum requirements:

- The travel must be directly related to the organization's mission, and all members must be eligible to participate, even if not selected.
- An event request must be submitted on Engage within the appropriate timeline (at least four weeks before the travel date for complex/travel outside of the DMV, or 2 weeks prior for simple/travel within the DMV). *You must have your CSI Advisor's initial approval for travel dates.*
- Submit a budget request to AUCC/GLC and/or a purchase request to the CSI Finance Department

through Engage.

- It is the organization's responsibility to ensure all participants complete a CSI-provided, event-specific travel waiver and submit emergency contact information at least 24 hours before the travel date. A waiver for your specific trip must be obtained by your CSI Advisor. RSOs must submit a roster of all trip attendees as well as contact information for the trip leader to CSI prior to departing for their trip. In case of emergency while traveling, RSOs are expected to contact 911 or local emergency services. After emergency services have been notified, RSOs are expected to contact AUPD if after hours, or CSI if during business hours. Then, RSOs must also follow up via email with their CSI advisor.
- See the Rental Cars & Driver Expectations section below for important driving expectations, for any trips involving driving.

Authorized travel expenses:

- Hotel lodging: the name of each student staying in the hotel must be provided to CSI when making the budget request/purchase request
    - **Overnight Accommodations:** Students participating in RSO-sponsored travel may be assigned to shared accommodations when appropriate to support responsible use of organization and University funds. Room assignments should be made in a manner that respects student privacy, dignity, and individual needs. Students will not be required to share a bed. Students may request specific or alternative rooming arrangements. Such requests should be submitted as early as possible and will be reviewed by the Center for Student Involvement (CSI) on a case-by-case basis, taking into consideration available accommodations, cost, safety, privacy, and any applicable University-approved accommodations. When a requested arrangement results in an additional cost that is not associated with an approved accommodation, the student may be responsible for the cost difference.
- Bus/train fare/rental car: for car rentals, the driver must be 21 years or older, and all tolls must be incorporated in the rental car fee
- Conference/convention registration costs
- Prepaid shuttles: one drop off/pick up for the entire group, and not for individual travel
- Lyft: see instructions below for requesting a Lyft waiver

Most approved travel expenses can be paid using the CSI credit card. RSOs can request up to $5,000 per year for student organization travel requests. The final amount allocated will be based on availability and need.

Unauthorized travel expenses:

- Airfare/flights, unless the travel is co-sponsored by CSI and receives prior approval from their CSI Advisor
- Airbnb/Home Rentals**:** rentals have terms and conditions, and the reservation needs to be paid for and listed under the occupant’s name, which goes against AU policy
- Traveling reimbursements unless the travel is co-sponsored by CSI and receives prior approval from

their CSI Advisor

Lyft Transportation Policy for RSOs

The Lyft program is designed to provide recognized student organizations with a transportation option that may be more cost-effective and convenient for certain university-related events and activities outside of the DMV Metro area, such as out-of-town travel or a professional development purpose (i.e., a conference). Generally, to use this program, the event venue or final destination cannot be accessible via Metro or other forms of public transportation in the DC Metro area, or public transportation is not a practical option. The following is a list of examples for when a Lyft may be used:

- From the airport to the event hotel
- From the hotel to the venue and back
- From the venue to the airport (if applicable)

When necessary, RSOs may be required to compare the total cost of Lyft rides (including multiple vehicles) with the cost of a bus rental to ensure the most economical option is selected. All non-local DMV Lyft transportation requests are classified as **complex events** and must be submitted at least four (3) weeks in advance to allow for proper review and processing. Travel with the local DMV area is considered simple and follows the simple events timeline.

Rental Cars & Driver Expectations

American University's preferred rental vendor is **Enterprise**. A rental car request is considered a complex request, if the rental is for non-local travel (outside the DMV). In order to use a rental car, **Drivers must be at least 21 years old.** Rentals will only be processed for drivers with driving privileges (see Driving Privileges requirements, outlined below). *Note:* CSI covers the rental fee and tolls paid via the EZPass device included in the vehicle and will provide reimbursements for gas within a university- rented vehicle. A rental **must be returned with a full tank of gas.** CSI provides options to RSOs who wish to travel via car (such as the Lyft program or rental car). Anyone driving a vehicle for RSO purposes/business must adhere to the following expectations:

- All vehicle operators must be approved drivers prior to the trip.
- Drivers must meet the Driver Acceptability Guidelines.
- Driving Privileges: Drivers must complete the AU Application for University Driving Privileges and Fair Credit Reporting Act MVR Verification Disclosure. Completed forms should be submitted to backgroundchecks@american.edu along with a copy of the front and back of their driver's license. Applications are typically reviewed within 48 hours.
- Drivers of personal vehicles must have a valid driver's license and automobile insurance policy. However, given the various alternate transportation options, as well as the availability of public transportation within the DMV, CSI does not recommend use of personal vehicles for RSO events/activities.
- All travelers must wear seat belts or other approved safety restraint devices required by law while the vehicle is in operation.
- Drivers are forbidden from using a cellular phone for any purpose while operating the vehicle.
- Groups may not plan to drive between the hours of 12am and 6am. This should only occur in the

event of an emergency.

- Organized group activities greater than five hundred (500) miles from American University's main campus are deemed un-drivable and the program must determine alternative transportation options.
- For every four (4) hours of driving, drivers must take a 20-minute break.
- Drivers assume all responsibility for any and all fines or traffic violations and citations associated with their use of a rental vehicle.
- Before leaving the parking area or garage, drivers should inspect the vehicle for safety concerns, checking the tires, wipers, lights, and other safety equipment for observable defects, and report any defects immediately to the prescribed authority to determine if the vehicle is safe to operate.
- Drivers are expected to follow the Vehicle Usage Guidelines.

Reimbursement

Reimbursement for RSO programming is rarely granted with limited exceptions, except as outlined below. CSI does not reimburse without prior approval by the Executive Director and after all appropriate forms have been submitted. Reimbursement must be in line with funding and programming timelines. Rare cases when reimbursements may be permitted include when items are purchased from vendors that do not accept CSI payment methods online or by phone and if items cannot be purchased directly from vendors, CSI is able to purchase them online or by phone. **Examples include:**

- Dry cleaners (e.g., RSO costume cleaning)
- Religious item retailers with limited payment options
- Local art or craft stores (e.g., supplies for cultural events)
- Gas stations (e.g., for approved travel when the CSI card is not accepted). Reimbursements must align with university policy, which can be found here.

Subscriptions

Annual subscriptions will only be considered for governance groups that support multiple organizations. All other organizations may request funding for subscriptions provided the subscription is essential to the mission of their organization (as documented in their mission statement) or can demonstrate that the subscription would reduce wasteful purchases or save money compared to non-subscription services.

On-Campus Movie Policy

Student organizations will need to obtain screening rights for any film they wish to show at an event, even if it is in the library's collection. The only exception is for films that the library has already purchased public performance rights for. To locate information related to university film screening rights, students can contact: mediaservices@american.edu with any questions regarding public performance rights, if that is the case, it will be listed on the catalog record.

For more information, please review this Guide to Showing Movies on Campus. Students can request screening rights at the website below and submit a budget/purchase request to their governing board:

- *Swank*: *www.swank.com*
    - Contact person- Caleb Wotring, *cwotring@swankmp.com* or 1800-876-5577

The event must be free of charge to AU students, not used as a fundraiser or revenue-generating of any kind, open only to AU students, and have an educational purpose. If an RSO would like to show a movie outside of these boundaries, they must include those terms in their request to Swank and ensure the proper rights are obtained.

The Federal Copyright Act makes it unlawful to show a film in public without explicit permission from the film's copyright owner. Renting or purchasing films from a streaming source or elsewhere gives the consumer the right to view the film, but not in public. In this context, the Copyright Act defines "public" as: "any place where a substantial number of persons outside of a normal circle of a family and its social acquaintances is gathered."

Vendors & Venues

AU venues must be prioritized before moving to off-campus venues. These spaces can be booked using the online scheduling platform, EMS, or by emailing the specific location's scheduling department (I.e., Washington College of Law, Katzen, and Kogod; see below for contact details for commonly used spaces). All events, whether off-campus or on-campus, must follow university guidelines.

You can find more information about University Event Scheduling here.

Catering

Student organizations planning events that include food or beverages must follow the University's Food Services Policy and all applicable purchasing, safety, sustainability, and event requirements.

Food Service Costs of $750 or Less: For food service expenses totaling $750 or less, student organizations may purchase food from vendors that comply with University purchasing requirements and applicable food safety standards.

Food Service Costs of $751 or More: When the total cost of Food Services is $751 or more and University Funds are being used, student organizations are required to use an Approved Caterer unless an exception has been granted.

CSI does not create catering reservations. RSOs should submit the request directly with the vendor (for AU Catering, RSOs should contact aucatering@american.edu directly) and get a quote before submitting a Purchase Request. In the PR, RSOs can provide the quote specify the organization, and issue it to American University. If possible, include a payment link in the purchase request.

Note: EZ Cater and the vendors included on that platform, Chartwells Catering, and Panera Catering, are the only forms of catering that can follow a simple timeline. All other catering requests are considered complex.

Food Vendors & Policies

The following is a list of important points to remember when requesting food for your organization:

- Food served at events that are open to the general campus community must be pre-packaged or prepared by contracted, licensed vendors. Bake sales are permitted, however, all items must be labeled with allergy information (i.e., gluten free, contains nuts) and organizations must follow the

Food Served for Non-Catered Events Guidance policy.

- Under the updated Food Services Policy, potlucks are allowed. Devices intended to maintain food at hot temperatures, such as sternos, slow cookers, induction devices, etc. may only be used under the supervision of an Approved Caterer or the Dining Services Provider. RSOs need to follow the Food Services policy, as well as the Food Served for Non-Catered Events Guidance policy when having food at events.
- Cookie decorating, gingerbread house, and other "build your own" type events are permitted, so long as those events comply with the Food Services Policy and the Food Served for Non-Catered Events Guidance. See section III for Safety Requirements, including barriers (gloves or serving utensils) and allergen labeling.
- RSOs cannot charge admittance, ask for donations, charge for the food at the event, or use the event as a fundraiser.
- When hosting events that have small food giveaways, please use individual or single-serving size items, such as juice boxes or individual prewrapped bakery goods.
- Student organizations cannot purchase from personal app accounts such as Uber Eats, GrubHub, and Door Dash, etc.
- If you know that your vendor is a first-time vendor check with CSI Finance to confirm we can work with them. Popular food vendors that would be considered a simple purchase include:
    - Panera
    - Dominos
    - Giant
    - Amazon
    - Target
    - Chipotle
    - Wegmans
    - EZ Cater
    - GrubHub
    - DoorDash
    - Instacart

Students must include a tip for delivery and other services as appropriate. Therefore, the tip **must be included** in the budget request and purchase request amounts. **Tips cannot exceed 20%.** Students are not permitted to add a tip or any additional charges to the credit card at the time of delivery. All anticipated costs, including tips, must be included in the original Purchase Request and or Budget Request. Adding any unapproved amount — even a tip — after approval is a violation of finance policy and may affect future funding approvals.

Contracts

All events including paid contracts are considered complex and must follow the complex event timeline. Further, ***all paid contracts must be managed by CSI Finance and are executed only by AU Procurement Department. Students and student organization advisors cannot initiate, sign or edit a contract on behalf of the organization or AU.*** Recognized student organizations are not official entities of the University. **Contracts should always be between a service provider and American University, never between the service provider and a specific individual or a club's name.**

Note: Recognized organizations under AUCC and GLC, must submit a budget request first with a quote from the vendor that shows the price of the service at least 4 **weeks** prior to the event. Once approved by AUCC and GLC organizations must then submit the purchase request to CSI Finance through

their Engage page. **Preferred vendor list can be found here**.

University Contracts

The following is a list of contracts that are commonly used for recognized student organization events.

- **Professional Services Agreement (PSA) for Individuals** - Suppliers providing non-speaker services that involve a single one-time simple service or product that will be rendered at one time/date. To process this agreement, an AU Worker Classification Questionnaire must be attached.
- **Professional Services Agreement (PSA) for Corporations**- University contract to use for events and services.
- **Speaker Agreement-** a university contract generated by CSI for a speaker that is requesting payment for their appearance
- **Speaker Agreement with Agent-** the speaker's agent serves as the primary form of contact and provides an agreement drafted by the agency/company to American University.
- **Guest Speaker Consent Form-** this can be reviewed and approved by the CSI Advisor for the organization. The agreement states that speakers will follow and respect AU speaker guidelines. When submitting an event on Engage, organizations can upload a copy of the Guest Speaker Consent Form with the speaker's signature and event details. Otherwise**,** a completed and signed form must be submitted to CSI **at least two weeks** prior to the event*. This agreement should be signed for all events with non-AU guest speakers, including presentations and workshops.
    - *If in the event the speaker does not agree with the terms of this form, the organization can connect the guest speaker with CSI's Finance department to send proposed changes to AU's Procurements and Contracts Office.
    - Please note that CSI and Procurement and Contracts Department may require additional review of Guest Speaker Consent Form for events with special guests, including hosting dignitaries, diplomats, government officials, or other public figures/celebrities, events with minors, non-AU guests, or 100 or more expected attendees
- **Concert Performance Agreement-** outlines the contractual terms between American University and artists/promoters/agents/talent for organizing and hosting musical events on campus including but not limited to bands, singing groups and individuals, ensuring clarity and compliance with financial arrangements, responsibilities, and event logistics.
- **PSA for Students Agreement-** to be used for students that are US Citizens, Permanent Residents or International Students with permission to work. Maximum payment value is $1,000.00.

Insurance Requirements for Performers, Promoters, and Caterers

In order for any performers, promoters, restaurants, and catering services to work with American University, they must provide a Certificate of General Liability Insurance with coverage of at least $1,000,000 (the required amount may vary depending on their classification tier) where American University is named as an additional insured. The insurance must be provided by a reputable company licensed in D.C., with an A.M. Best rating of A- VII or higher. At least 3 weeks before the event takes place, the certificate must be submitted to the CSI Finance Department and issued to:

American University
4400 Massachusetts Ave NW
Washington, DC 20016

All rights to claim against the University must be waived in the policy (waiver of subrogation). This does not apply to vendors included in the EZ Cater platform.

Sole Source Justification Process (For Services Exceeding $10,000)

When selecting a vendor for services exceeding $10,000, a Sole Source Justification must be completed as part of the procurement process. Please follow the steps below:

1. **Gather Quotes and Vendor Responses**
   Obtain quotes from multiple vendors. Document all vendor responses, including any instances of non-response.
2. **Select a Vendor**
   Identify the vendor you intend to work with. Whenever possible, select the lowest responsive and responsible vendor.
3. **Complete the Sole Source Justification Form**
   Provide a clear and detailed explanation of the rationale for selecting the chosen vendor over others.
4. **Attach Documentation to the Purchase Requisition (PR)**
   Attach the completed Sole Source Justification Form, along with all supporting documentation, to the PR at the time of submission.

External Contracts

External contracts typically include additional terms and conditions that the University needs to negotiate, which take longer to be approved, depending on edits. **ALL** external contracts will be sent to PCD by the CSI finance team. These include, but are not limited to:

- Campus venues contracts (space rental)
- Speaker engagements
- Bands and other musicians
- Bus rentals
- Invoices with terms and conditions

Contracts are only considered complete once both parties have signed, and the vendor has submitted their financial documents to AU.

Vendor Policy for American University Grounds

Vendors who come to sell or promote merchandise on campus are required to follow the Mary Graydon Student Center (MGSC) vending policies. This includes vendors brought by RSOs free of charge who are selling or showcasing their goods directly to the AU community. They must complete the On-Campus Vending Application form and pay the required vending fee by check. For more information or to begin the process, please email afish@american.edu.

Donations & Fundraisers (with Limited Exceptions)

Student Activity Fees cannot be directly used for donations. Instead, a recognized student organization can sponsor a fundraising program to support a non-University organization if the following conditions are met:

- Student activity fee funds were not used to buy supplies or items that would be donated to an external organization, student activity fee funds are not used to purchase items for re-sale (the proceeds from which will be donated), and student activity fee funds are not used as a donation.
- Student activity fees funds may be used to purchase event supplies, decorations, and food for the event, provided they are not used for any of the above.
- The net profits are donated. The organization **cannot** make a profit from it.
- If these parameters are followed, the organization can donate the funds in the following two ways:
    - Donating Collected Funds via Student Organization: The organization collects fundraising money and then works with the charity of their choice on the delivery of funds via ACH (Direct Deposit) or paper check
    - Donating Collected Funds via the Center for Student Involvement: This should be done from the Clubs's Revenue Account.
        - **Transfer of Funds**
          The organization must first transfer the collected funds to American University via ACH or by issuing a check payable to American University.
        - Submit a Funding Request (Deposit) * See "Funding Request" section on the manual.
        - **Confirmation of Funds**
          Organizations must notify the CSI Finance Team via email of any incoming transfers. Funds will appear in Engage only after receipt has been confirmed.
        - **Submit a Purchase Request (Donation)**
          After the funds are available in the Engage account, the organization must submit a Purchase Request. Follow the instructions outlined in the **"Purchase Request "** section of the manual.
        - **Processing Payment to Charity**
          CSI Finance will review the request, process the payment via check or credit card directly to the selected charity.

Note: *AU cannot donate funds to an organization on behalf of a guest speaker.*

<u>The Bridge / The Dav Fundraising</u>

RSOs may organize fundraising at The Bridge or The Dav to donate to a charity through Drink of the Month fundraisers. The Bridge requires that all RSOs hosting a Drink of the Month fundraiser donate the proceeds to a nonprofit organization either on or off AU's campus or utilize these funds as revenue in their on-campus organizational account. The Bridge and The DAV will provide the RSO an invoice for the funds collected.

Once received, follow the steps under section "Donations and Fundraisers" No funds will be transferred directly from The Bridge or The Dav to either students or to the charity.

Student Fee Accounts

All RSO funding accounts must be tied to the RSO and American University. Organizations **cannot** have an account outside of AU.

Allocation accounts

These accounts house RSO budgets based on the allocation determined by the Budget Advisory Council and/or the respective governance board. This funding is used to submit budget and purchase requests on Engage. Any unused funds remaining at the end of the year will be reallocated back to the council that oversees the student organization and/or CSI.

Revenue accounts

These accounts hold funds that an RSO receives through donations or fundraisers and is managed by CSI Finance. Use of the account must follow CSI and American University guidelines and policies. For example, the following are permitted:

- Graduation Cords.
- Stipend for Student Staff
- To purchase additional merchandise that exceeds any limits we have set
- Magazine printing for distribution on campus.

Reserve accounts

These accounts are tied to CSI governance groups and carry over year to year. Each governance group is required to have a process approved by CSI to access the funds. Reserve accounts are meant to support one time/special initiatives or supplement budgets in a deficit. Governance groups are generally not allowed to hold more than $100,000 in reserve funds at any given time; unused funds above $100,000 will be redirected to the Student Engagement Impact Fund each year.

Organization Materials

Promotional Items

RSOs can purchase **up to $200 worth** of items for general promotional items (excluding merchandise as defined below) **once per semester**. These items include keychains, pop sockets, pins/buttons, totes, and laptop stickers that include the RSO's name or logo.

Costumes

Any costume(s) purchased for performances or events must be reusable and stored on campus. All costumes purchased using Student Activity Fee funds must not be construed as personal in nature and/or for one-time use. Once used, organizations must have the items professionally dry-cleaned, packed up appropriately, and returned to the storage closet.

Merchandise

These includes any apparel items, such as T-shirts, hoodies, hats, socks, and other wearable items, that display an RSO's logo or name. Student organizations can purchase merchandise items **once per**

academic calendar year. Merchandise purchases are capped at $30 per item. Proofs of artwork as well as intended use of the AU logo must be included in the request to be approved by CSI Finance.

Magazine Printing

Only Student Media organizations are approved to print magazines for campus-wide distribution. Groups may be approved to print publications with more limited distribution on a case-by-case basis.

Financial Co-Sponsorships of Events

Co-sponsorships are commitments with other student organizations to partially handle the cost, management, and/or marketing of the event. RSOs can serve as financial co-sponsors for events or programs with other RSOs, departments, or schools, when there is clear evidence the RSO is an active participant in the planning, marketing, and execution of the event. RSOs cannot financially cosponsor events with unrecognized student organizations, or fund college or departmental events.

Student Activity Fee funds **cannot** fund university department events. If an organization is co-sponsoring an event with a department, the organization must provide an email between the department and group to CSI clearly outlining the organization's role in the event. No organization should be confirming financial co-sponsorship of a departmental event prior to a event approval.

Types of Co-Sponsorships

- **Organizations Under the Same Governance Group:** We encourage organizations within the same governance group (AUCC, Student Media, GLC/GSC, etc.) to collaborate on events. To do this, each organization must split the costs associated with the event and fill out a separate budget or purchase request indicating the requested funds.
- **Organizations Under Different Governance Groups:** If an organization from one governance group seeks collaboration with another, only the governance group making a purchase should submit a budget/purchase request for the item(s) the group contributes. To encourage mutual collaboration, it's recommended that each group contribute a similar amount to the event through funding, marketing efforts, and the planning and execution of the event.
- **Organizations with University Departments**: When a student organization is **transferring funds to a university department** as part of a collaborative event or initiative, the organization must submit a Purchase Request (PR) for the transfer. The PR must include the email correspondence confirming the collaboration and the agreed-upon funding arrangement between the organization and the department. When a student organization is **receiving funding from a university department**, the organization must email the CSI Finance Office requesting that the funds be transferred. The email must include the email thread confirming the collaboration and the department's commitment to provide funding. This documentation allows the CSI Finance Office to request and process the transfer of funds.

Things SAF Cannot Be Used For

The following are examples where the Student Activity Fee cannot be used, but note that the list is

not exhaustive, and there may be other usages to which this policy applies.

Revenue-Generating Items

SAF funds **may not be used to generate a profit**. This includes the purchase of any items intended for **resale during fundraising**, regardless of whether the proceeds are for RSO revenue or charitable donations. Such items include, but are not limited to, merchandise, stickers, baked goods, and tickets for raffles). This restriction applies regardless of how the items are categorized or labeled (e.g., promotional materials, giveaways with suggested donations, etc.). SAF funds may be used for decorations, supplies, or materials that support general RSO operations or event execution, as long as they are not tied to revenue-generating activities.

Charging for Events

Student Activity Fee funds **cannot** be used for events where students will be charged. This includes charging for entry, food, or a required donation. Any optional donation received can be processed following the Donations and Fundraising section.

Dues

Generally, RSOs **cannot** charge membership dues to students. If an organization is charging dues, its constitution must explain the amount and how the money is used.

Organizations that are part of a national organization that require a chapter membership fee are eligible to request funding. It must clearly state in the constitution any dues collected go directly to the national organization. These organizations must meet the eligibility rules for funding.

Alcohol

Alcohol is **NOT** allowed at any undergraduate RSO event, whether it is held on or off-campus. If graduate-level groups are interested in hosting an event at a venue that sells alcohol, they must follow the appropriate procedures listed under the *Alcohol Service at University Events policy*.

Flammable items

Flammable items such as matches, lighters, coal, and fuel are prohibited.

Weapons

Weapons such as firearms, explosives, blades, and knives are prohibited. Devices that spray water, so long as they do not look like a water gun or weapon, are permitted.

Gift Cards

Gift cards cannot be purchased from external vendors. They also must not be used as a method of payment to vendors. You may request a rewards card for a student as a prize. However, once issued, how the recipient uses the card is outside of AU's purview. Please note that receiving a rewards card may have tax implications for the recipient. To view available gift card options, visit the Tango catalog:
https://www.tangocard.com/reward-catalog

Graduation Cords

Graduation cords are not able to be purchased because they only benefit a select few of the RSO. Instead, groups can purchase graduation cords on their own, but the cords must be registered with the Special Events Office by contacting Lindsay Studer at studer@american.edu. This is permitted with dues or revenue but not allocated funds.

Prizes

Prizes cannot be purchased under the following circumstances:

- If it requires specific actions like signing petitions or making a pledge
- If it is advocacy-based or a political incentive
- If it's being purchases for exclusive or restricted events
- Personal rewards, including for organizers

Otherwise, prizes must support inclusive, educational, and engaging student experiences and be given at events that are open to all students. Examples include modest prizes (typically $25 or less), random drawings, trivia, or games, participation-based (not belief- or action/incentive-based).

Individually Purchased Tickets

Individually purchased event tickets will not be approved. Group tickets can be purchased on a case-by-case basis. Examples of such events include entrance to museums and shows. Please note that this policy does not apply to conference registrations or train and bus tickets.

Student Vendor Payments

Students can only be paid as vendors when they provide a service for an event or program open to the campus community being hosted by an RSO beyond their involvement or position within an organization.

Student Engagement Impact Fund

All RSOs can apply for additional funding every spring semester through the Student Engagement Impact Fund. This process reallocates unused Student Activity funds strategically and responsibly to programs that demonstrate clear potential to enhance student retention and engagement. The Budget Advisory Committee (BAC) evaluates the proposals and grants funding based on the following:

- Alignment with Goals
- Budget Justification
- Impact Potential
- Feasibility
- Assessment Plan
- Innovation

Calls for submissions are announced in the spring. Find out more about this process here.

AUCC Base Funds

Base Funding is a limited allocation provided by the American University Club Council (AUCC) to help Registered Student Organizations (RSOs) cover basic operational and promotional expenses at the beginning of the academic year. Organizations that express interest in receiving BASE Funding and meet AUCC's eligibility criteria may receive an allocation based on funding availability and the annual review process.
Each eligible organization is allocated **$300** in Base Funding. These funds are available for use **without submitting a Budget Request to AUCC**. Organizations may proceed directly to the Purchase Request process, provided all purchases comply with applicable AUCC and CSI policies.
RSOs are encouraged to use their Base Funding during the **first four weeks of the semester** to support early-semester engagement and recruitment efforts.

Eligible Expenses

BASE Funding may be used for items such as:

- General supplies (e.g., stickers, flyers, individually wrapped candy, pens, buttons)
- Materials and supplies for the Involvement Fair
- Beginning-of-semester social events
- Tabling activities
- Welcome Back events

All purchases made using Base Funding must comply with the policies and procedures outlined in this manual, the RSO Manual, and all applicable AUCC and CSI policies.

Tracking and Accountability

The organization's Treasurer is responsible for monitoring Base Funding expenditures throughout the year. AUCC Consultants also track spending to ensure organizations remain within their allocated funding and comply with university policies.

Organization Accounting on Engage

The Center for Student Involvement uses the Engage financial platform to assign accounts to student organizations. From these accounts, the organization can submit Budget, Purchase, and Funding requests to document transactions in detail. The transactions show how much of their request was approved, when the money was moved between accounts, and more.

Budget Request

Organizations under AUCC & GLC use this tab to request funding for a specific event. This is reviewed for approval or denial by the AUCC Club Consultants or GLC Director of Finance, depending on the governance board the organization is under. RSOs submit one budget request per event. It should include all requested purchases for the event.

It is the individual organization’s responsibility to review their governance board and CSI policies and timelines to ensure they are requesting and receiving funding in time for their event. Organizations under the American University Club Council can follow the AUCC Budget Request Quick Guide and

organizations under the Graduate Leadership Council can contact the GLC VP of Finance at vp.finance@auglc.org.

Budget Request approval is not the end of the process, a purchase request must be submitted.

Purchase Request

RSOs under AUCC or GLC/GSCs, must receive approval for their budget request before submitting a purchase request. Purchase requests are used to access the approved allocated funds that are in the organization's account. Only items approved during the budget request process can be submitted on a purchase request.

Note: The group cannot request more in their purchase request than what they were originally allocated for in their approved budget request. Organizations not under AUCC or GLC work with their CSI Advisor to submit a purchase request to the CSI Finance Department as the first finance step.

Once approved, no additional purchases will be made for the event without a new purchase request. The new request must be in timeline and have also been approved by the appropriate governance group. Be sure to follow the instructions provided by the CSI Finance team on how to submit a Purchase Request to ensure your request isn't denied and your event isn't delayed.

Account Deposit - Funding Request

This form is used for organizations that need to pay dues, or to request funds to be delivered to the organization's revenue account generated from a fundraiser.

If the organization organizes a fundraiser without using funding from the Student Activity Fee, it may use the proceeds as revenue. Here are the steps to do so:

a. Submit a Funding Request on Engage.
b. ACH Deposit or drop off checks or money orders to our office. The checks should be issued to **American University only.** No cash is accepted.
c. Once ACH has been confirmed or the check has been cleared, funds will be deposited into the organization's Revenue account.
d. If the proceeds are being donated, a Purchase Request should be submitted after the deposit has been cleared.

Unrecognized Organization Account Balances

If a student organization becomes inactive, is no longer recognized, or separates from the University and there are no active efforts or plans for the organization to return within 2 years, the Center for Student Involvement, with approval from the AVP for Student Engagement, may reallocate any remaining fundraised funds to student organizations that closely align with the original Organization's mission.